

GREEN STITCH

Living in a Continuum of Nature & Community

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Studio C, Dwelling Lab, Proposition Report

MANCHESTER SCHOOL
OF ARCHITECTURE

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01 INTRODUCTION & ANALYSIS

PROJECT INTRODUCTION

Collyhurst Context

South Collyhurst is undergoing a period of rapid transformation driven by the wider Victoria North regeneration programme. While new housing developments are increasing residential density, the railway corridor continues to divide neighbourhoods and limit connections between existing and emerging communities. At the same time, a fragmented network of parks and open spaces presents an opportunity to create a more connected landscape structure. The project investigates how green infrastructure can support suburban intensification by transforming barriers into community connectors.

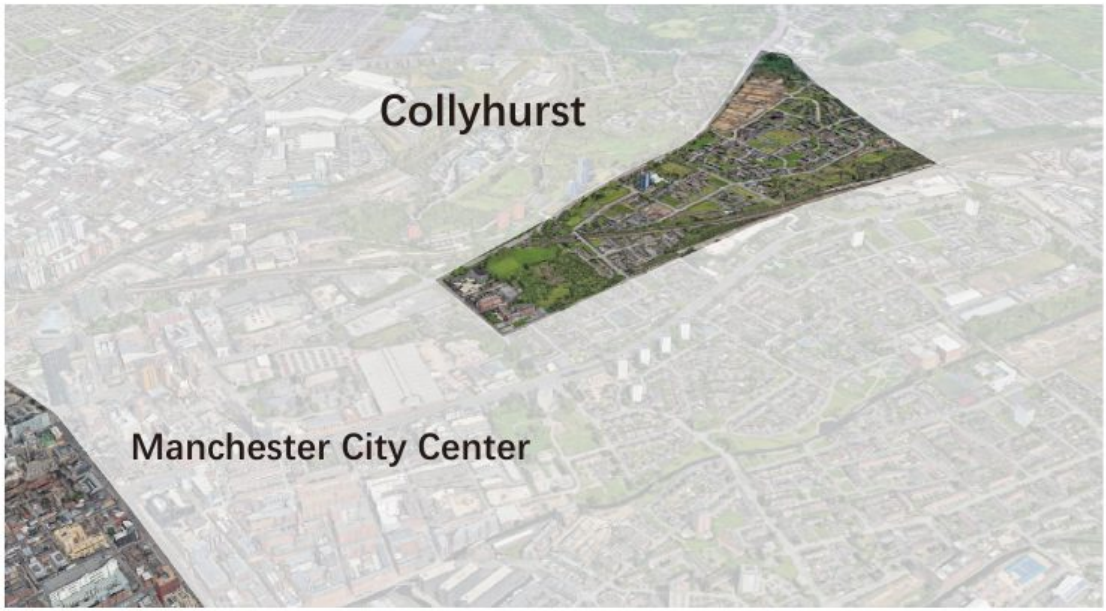


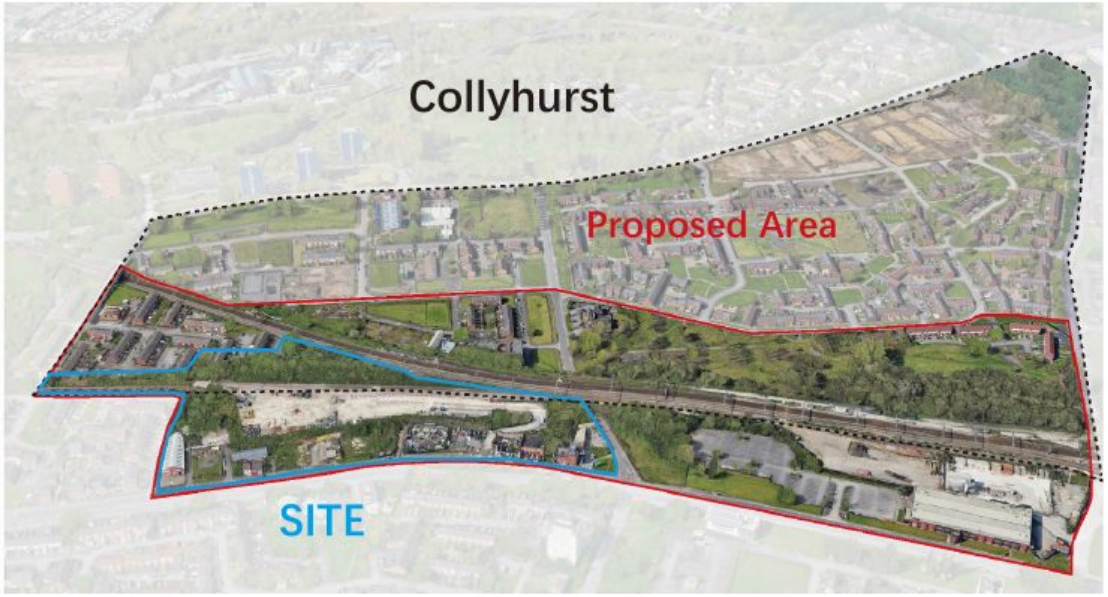
Figure 2: Area covered by Manchester Northern Gateway Strategic Regeneration Framework. (Manchester Northern Gateway, 2019, p.4).

Project Aim

The aim of the project is to establish a model of "Corridor Living" that integrates green infrastructure, housing and community life. Through a connected network of parks, courtyards and pedestrian routes, the proposal seeks to create a landscape-led neighbourhood that supports everyday interaction, ecological continuity and long-term urban regeneration.

Site Location





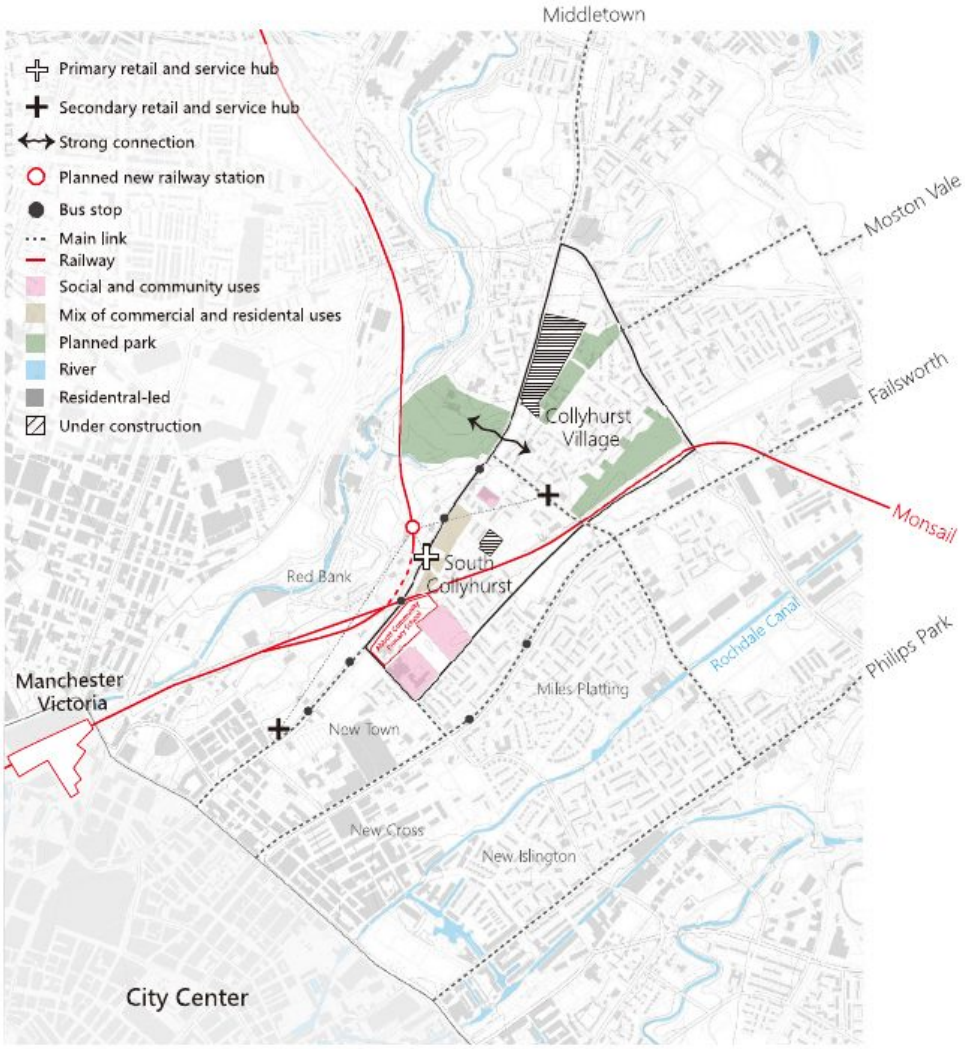
PROJECT INTRODUCTION

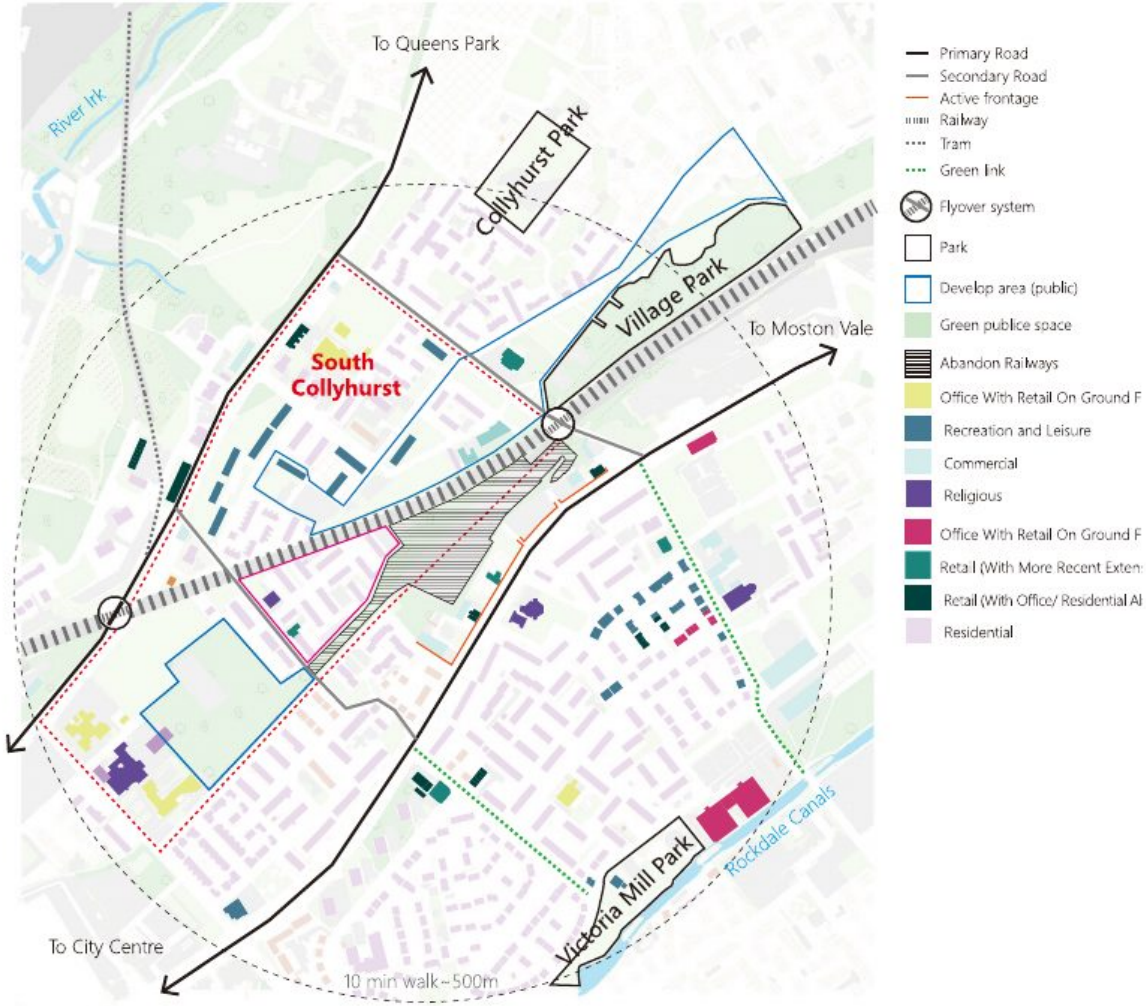
Northern Gateway Profile

South Collyhurst forms part of the wider Manchester Northern Gateway regeneration area. Its strategic location between the city centre and emerging residential districts positions it as a key area for future growth and development.

Collyhurst Profile

South Collyhurst is surrounded by existing neighbourhoods, parks and future development sites. The railway corridor currently acts as a barrier, while the surrounding green network presents opportunities for improved connectivity and community integration.

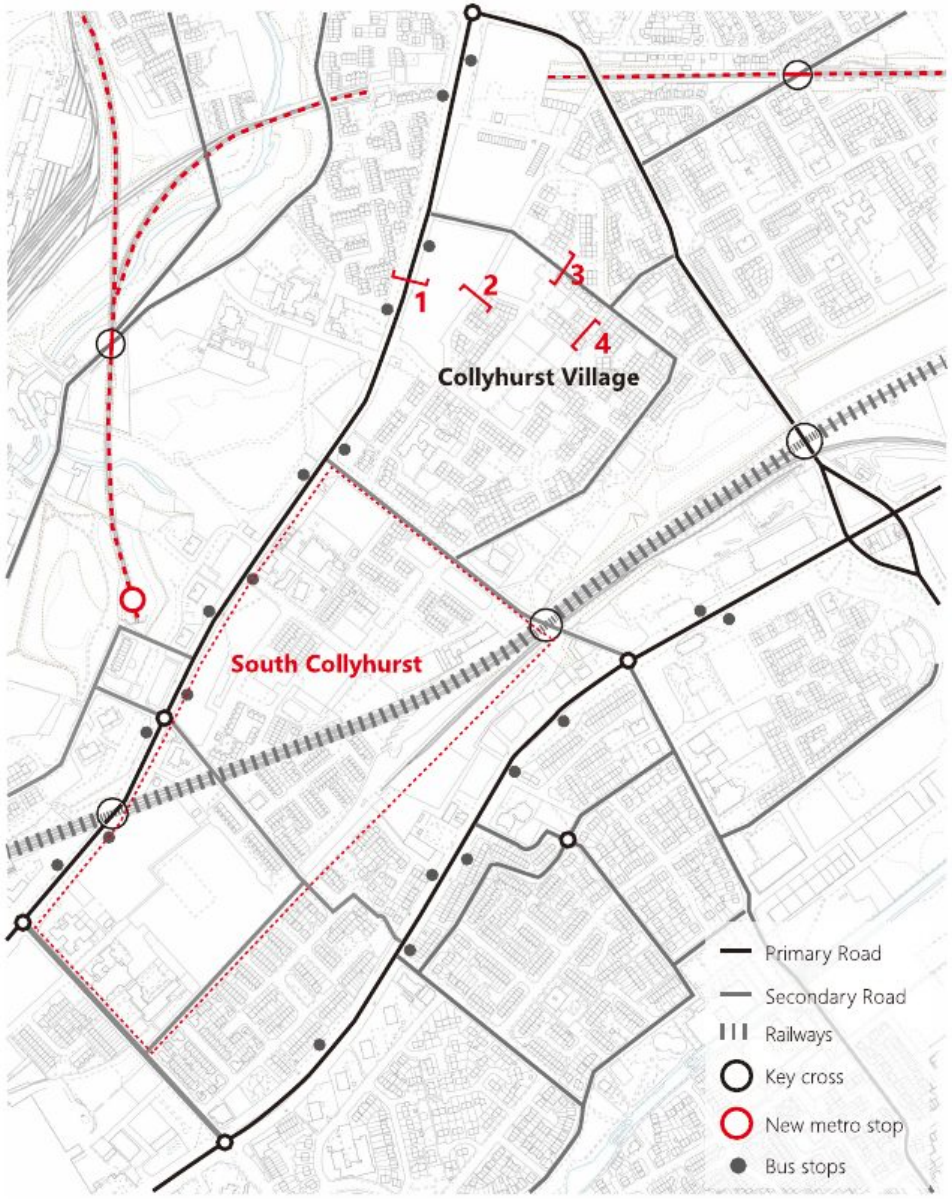




EXISTING CONDITIONS

Connectivity Mapping

South Collyhurst benefits from strong connections to surrounding neighbourhoods and public transport infrastructure. However, movement across the site remains fragmented, with limited east–west connectivity and restricted access between existing communities and future development areas.



Historical Mapping

Collyhurst developed as a railway and industrial neighbourhood during the nineteenth century. While much of the historic urban fabric has been transformed through redevelopment, the railway corridor remains a defining element of the area's identity and spatial structure.

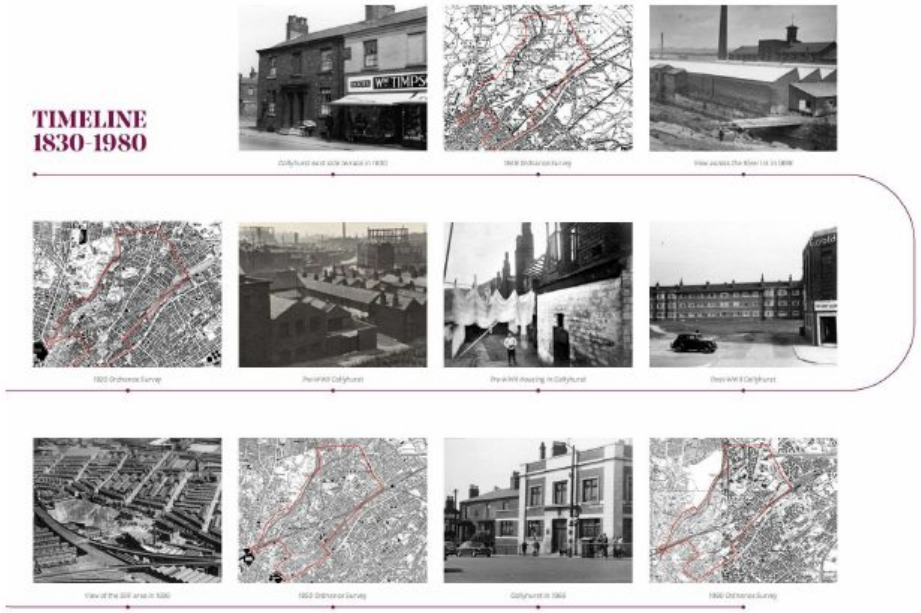
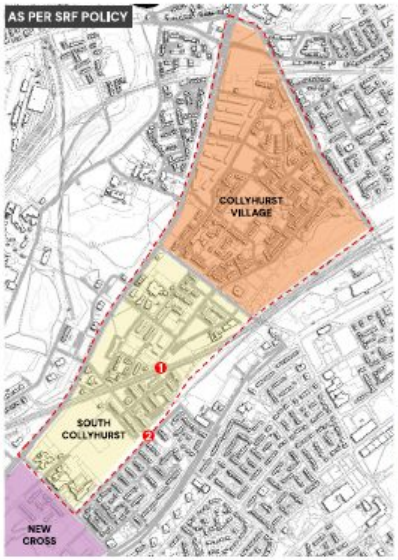
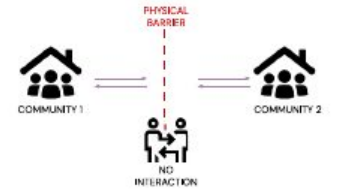


Image source:STRATEGIC REGENERATION FRAMEWORK MANCHESTER NORTHERN GATEWAY February 2019









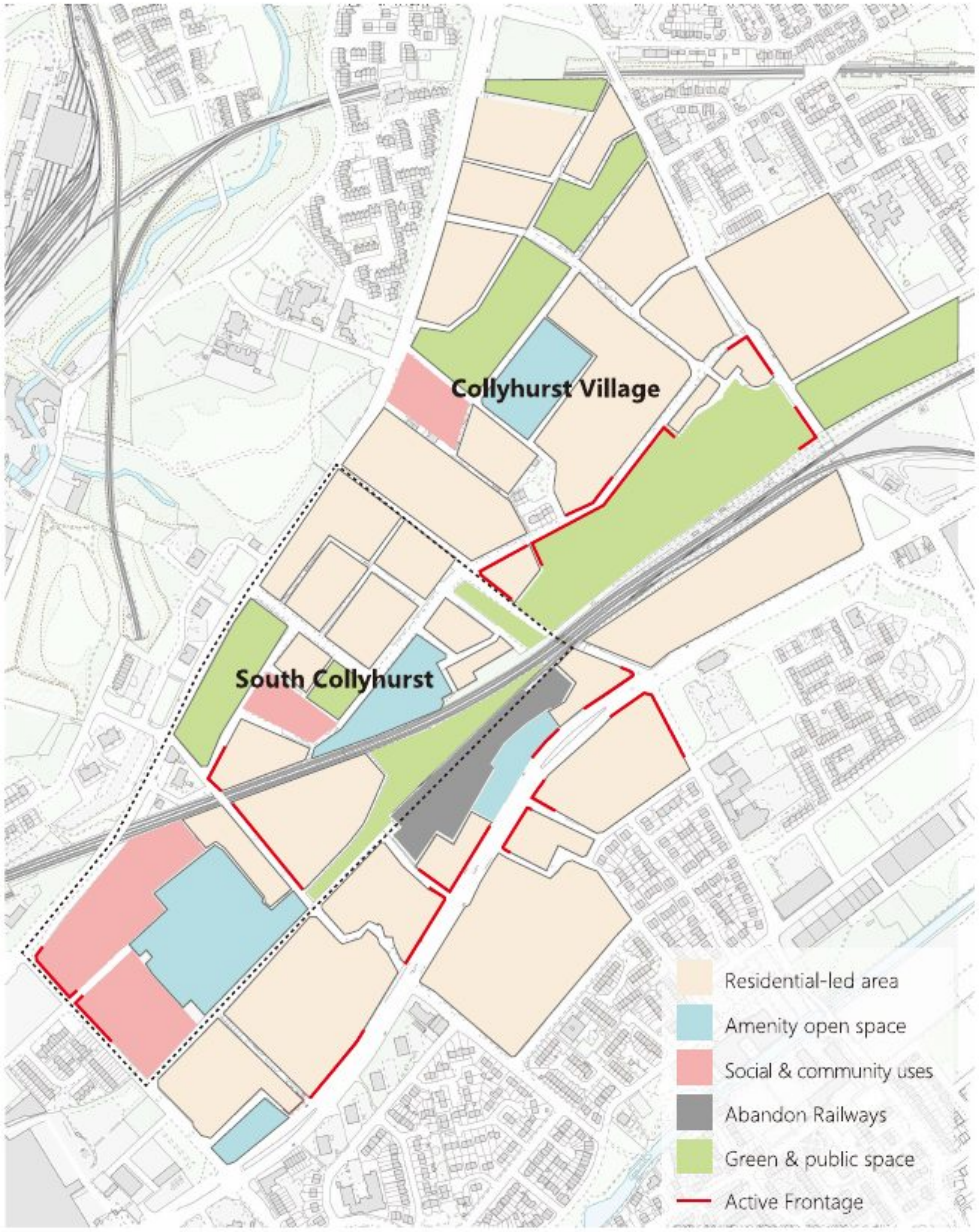
Railway Barrier

The railway corridor creates a significant physical and visual barrier between South Collyhurst and Collyhurst Village, limiting movement and reducing interaction between neighbouring communities. Reconnecting these areas presents a key opportunity for future regeneration.

EXISTING CONDITIONS

Land Use Mapping

The site is predominantly residential, supported by green spaces, community facilities and local amenities. This mix of uses provides a strong foundation for future neighbourhood growth and regeneration.



Soft and Hard Mapping

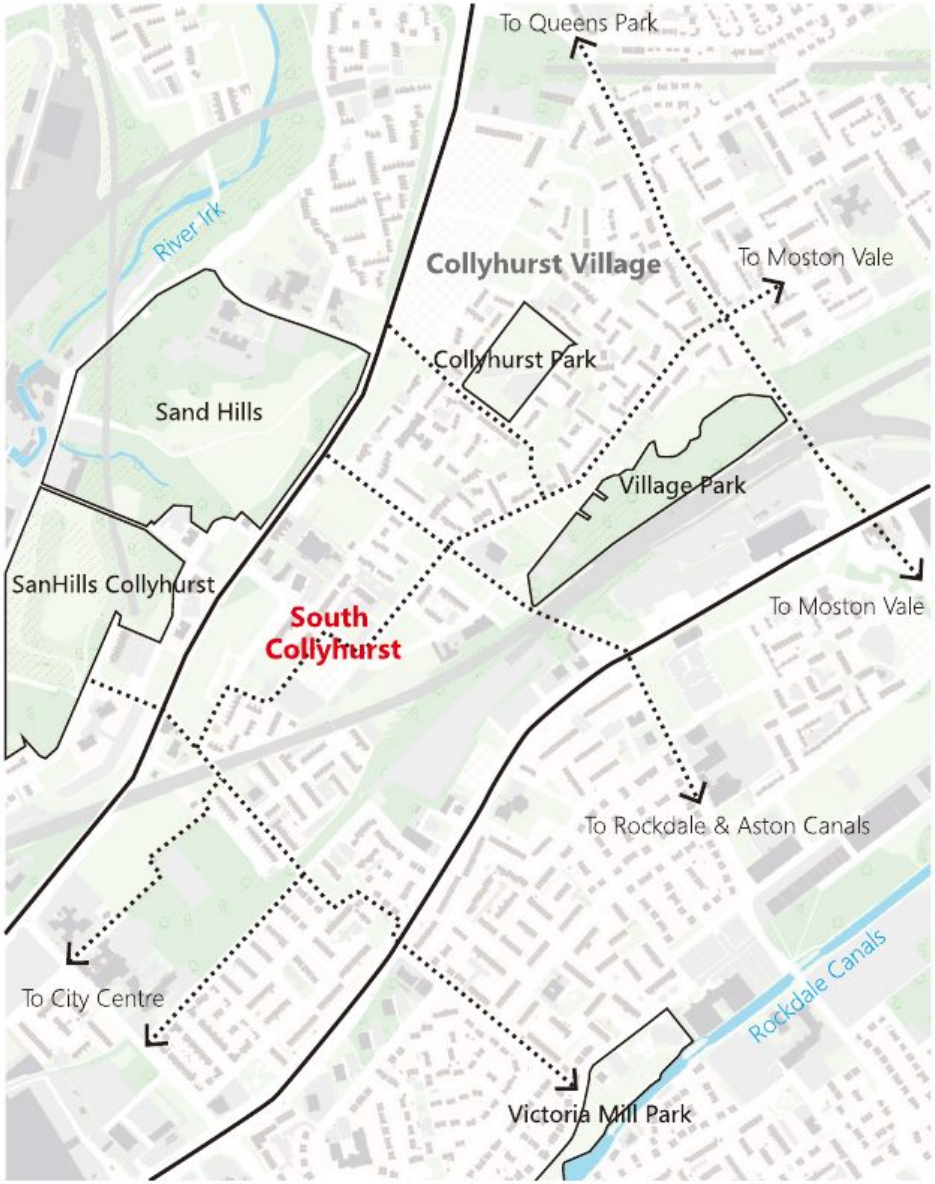
The analysis identifies areas suitable for future intervention alongside established neighbourhood assets. This approach supports regeneration while retaining the existing character and community structure of Collyhurst.



EXISTING CONDITIONS

Green Network

A network of parks and open spaces surrounds the site, providing important ecological and recreational resources. The project aims to connect these fragmented landscapes into a continuous green corridor.



Material Analysis



Historic Railway Viaduct



Red brick | iron Railings | Stone bricks

Red brick, stone foundations and iron railings reflect Collyhurst's industrial heritage. The material palette provides a strong identity that continues to shape the character of the area.



Existing Residential Housing



Red brick | Aluminium Alloy | Iron Railings | Iron Door

Traditional housing is characterised by red brick façades, simple material detailing and front garden boundaries, contributing to the established suburban character of Collyhurst.



Contemporary Housing Development



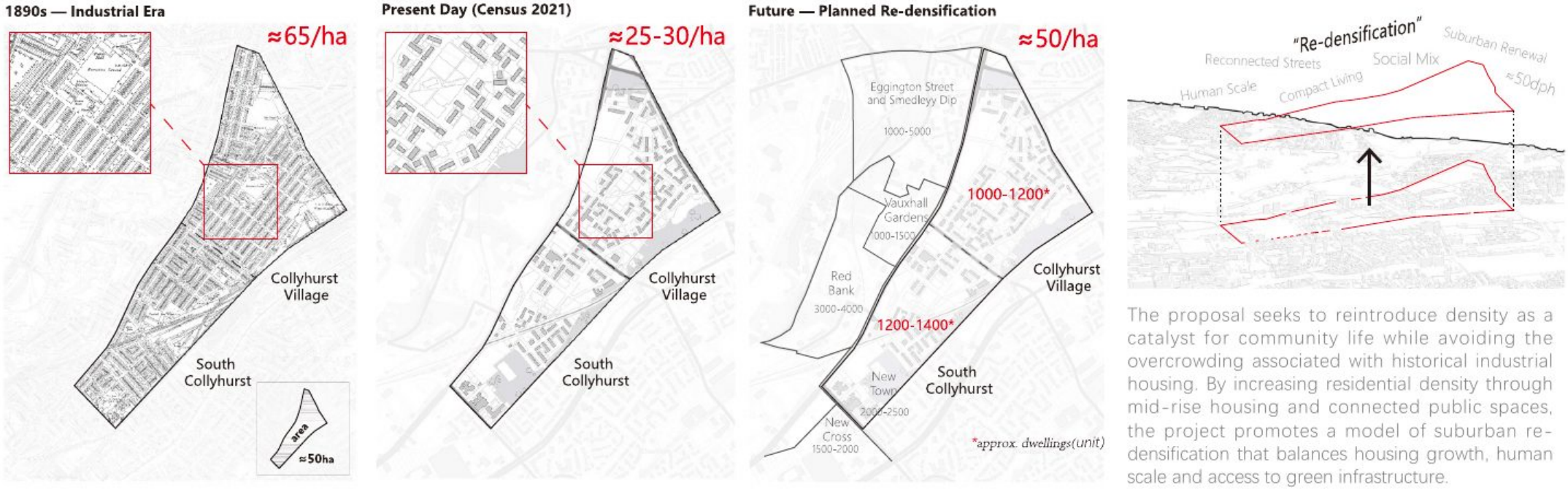
Yellow Bricks | Timber | Wooden Doors | Aluminium Alloy

New residential developments reinterpret traditional brick architecture through lighter materials, larger openings and timber detailing, creating a contemporary response to the local context.

Collyhurst is characterised by a robust palette of brick, stone and metal elements rooted in its industrial heritage. Contemporary developments reinterpret these materials through the introduction of timber and aluminium, creating a dialogue between historic character and modern living.

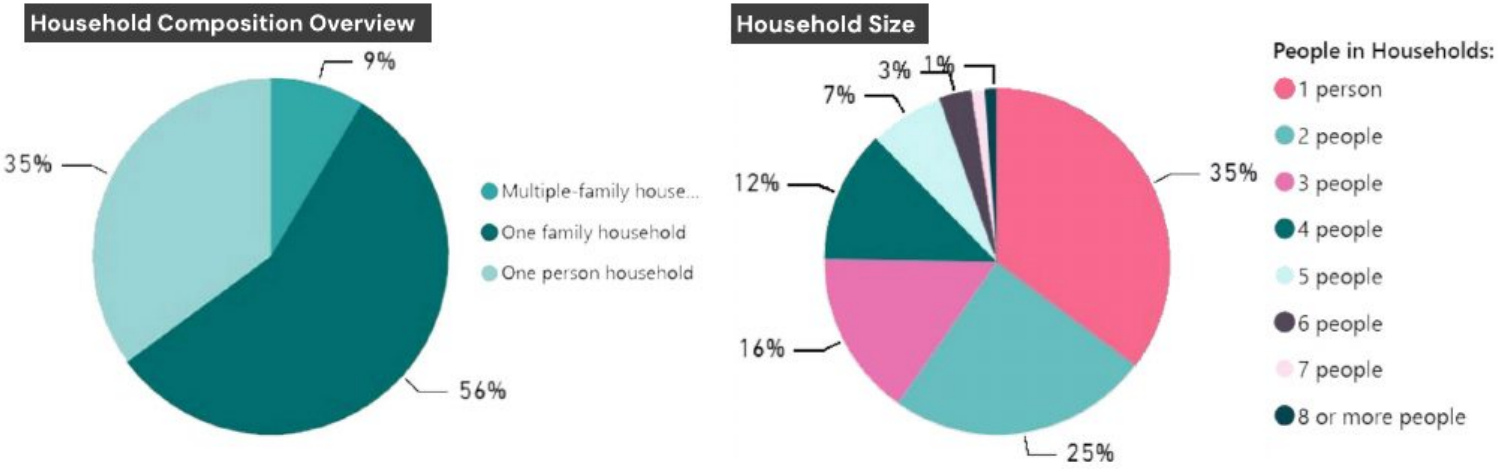
EXISTING CONDITIONS

Density Mapping



The proposal seeks to reintroduce density as a catalyst for community life while avoiding the overcrowding associated with historical industrial housing. By increasing residential density through mid-rise housing and connected public spaces, the project promotes a model of suburban re-densification that balances housing growth, human scale and access to green infrastructure.

Demographic Mapping



Data Sources: Census 2021 (Nomis/0NS) and Manchester City Council



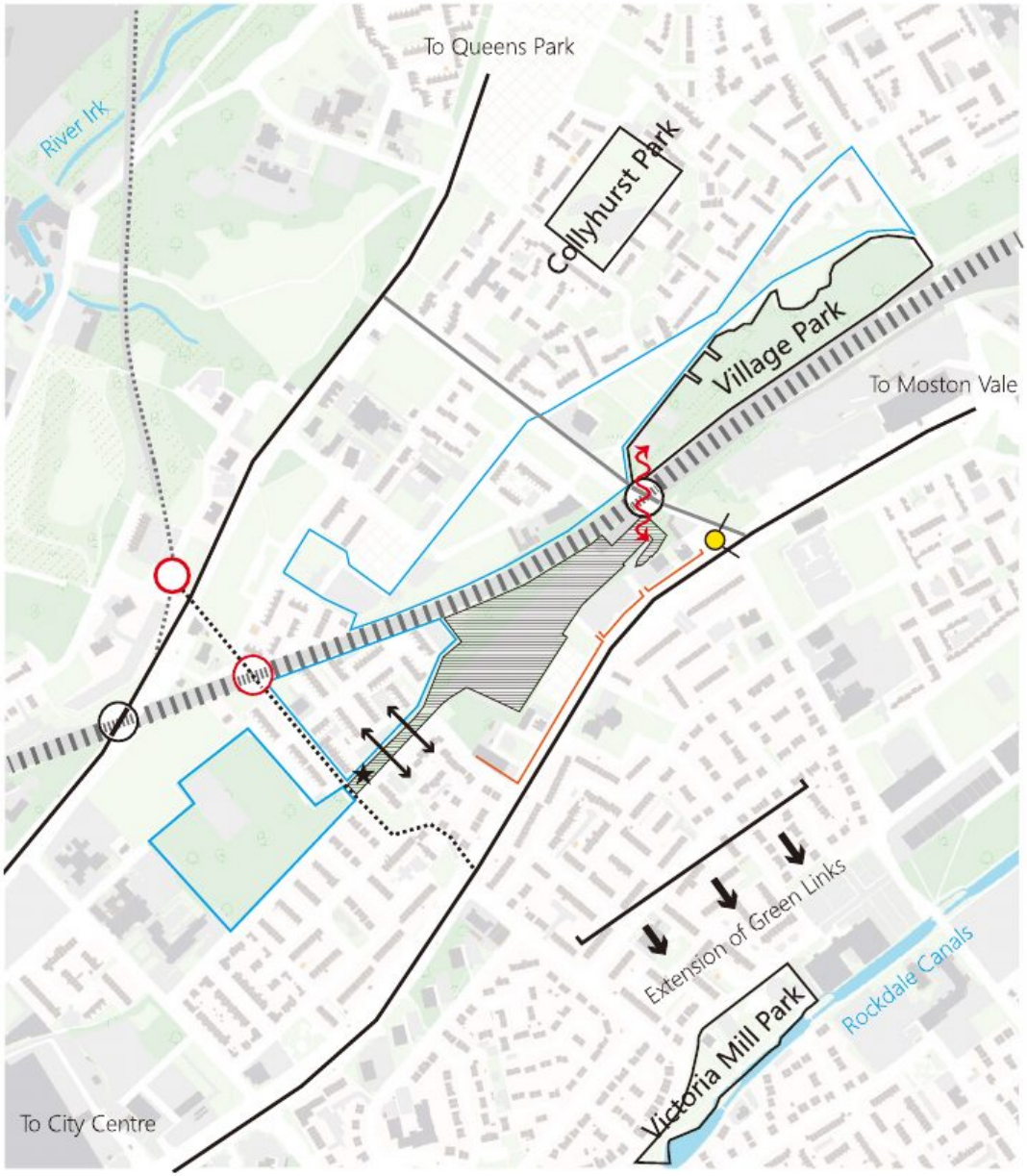
Protest as residents 'in limbo' over home demolition

To attract and retain young residents by creating a connected, affordable and community-oriented neighbourhood. The proposal combines diverse housing types, shared green spaces and everyday social infrastructure to support contemporary lifestyles and strengthen long-term community growth.

SITE ANALYSIS

Site Overall

The site occupies a strategic position between existing communities, parks and future development areas. Its unique location provides opportunities to transform fragmented infrastructure into a connected network of landscape, housing and public space.



Key Issues

The analysis identifies a series of spatial opportunities that can support future regeneration. Improving connectivity, activating key public frontages, strengthening green infrastructure and establishing new community destinations form the foundation of the proposed design strategy.

A Future Road Connection



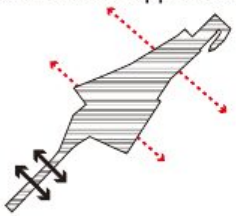
Key road sections offer strong potential for improved future connectivity.

B Community Focal Point



A highly visible corner ideal for a future community focal point.

C Green Corridor Opportunity



Railway edges provide an opportunity to create a continuous green corridor.

D Active Street Frontage



The main road frontage holds potential for a vibrant active edge.

E Flyover Green Connection



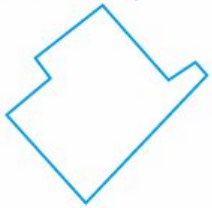
The flyover opens opportunities to link green spaces across both sides.

F Historic Local Landmark



The historic arch bridge offers potential to become a local landmark.

G Community Development



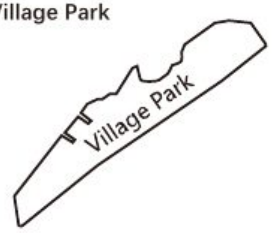
New development areas can integrate strongly with community public spaces.

H Development Area



New tram stops provide opportunities to enhance mobility and access.

I Village Park



Village Park has potential for enhanced development and community use.

02 VISION & MASTERPLAN

DESIGN VISION

Corridor Living Vision

Corridor Living reimagines South Collyhurst as a landscape-led neighbourhood where green infrastructure becomes the framework for movement, community and housing. By transforming the railway corridor from a barrier into a connector, the proposal creates a network of parks, courtyards and public spaces that support social interaction, ecological continuity and sustainable urban growth.



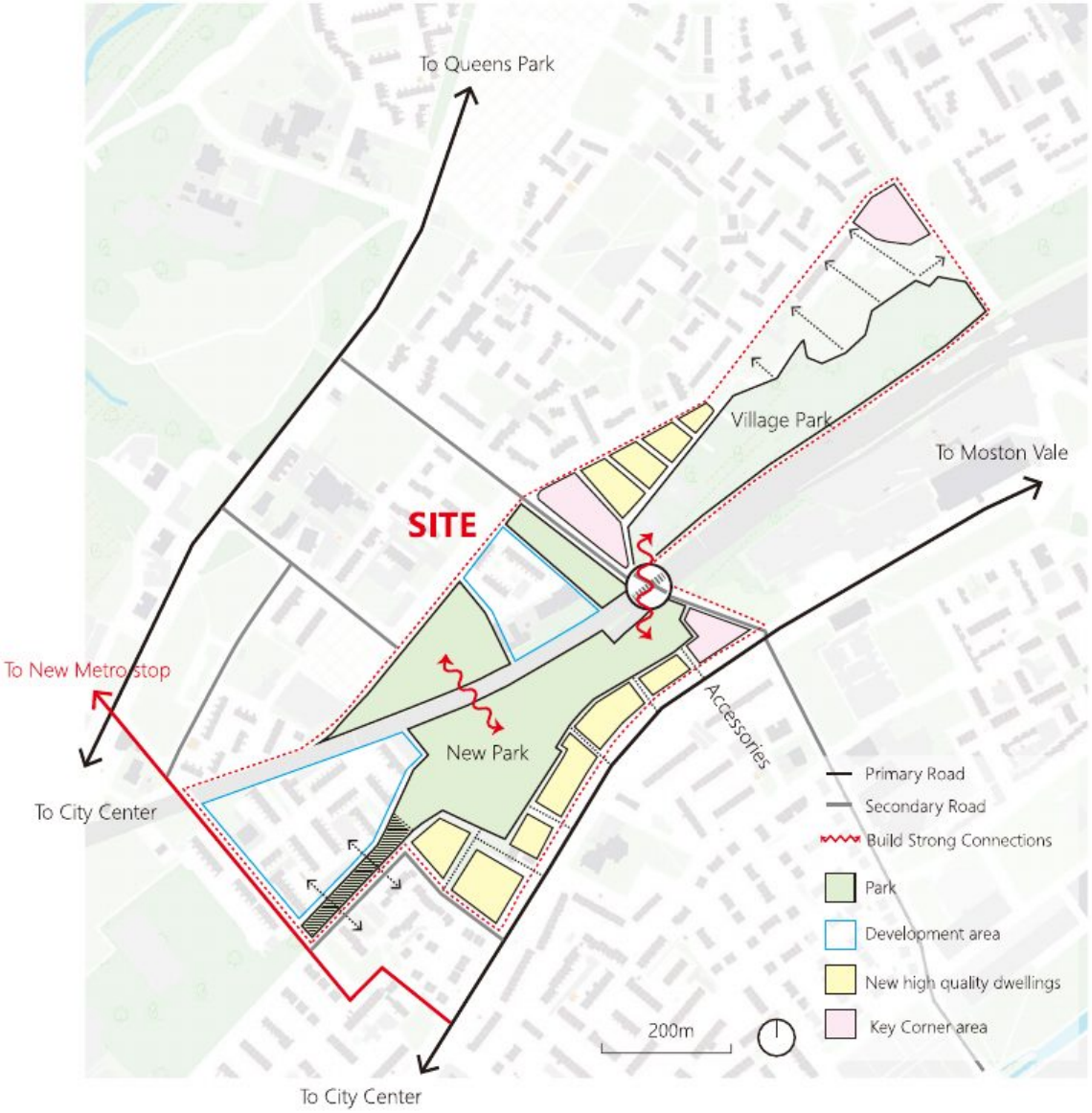
From Barrier to Connector

The proposal transforms the railway corridor from a physical barrier into a landscape connector. By linking parks, neighbourhoods and new housing through a continuous green corridor, the project strengthens movement, community interaction and ecological connectivity across South Collyhurst.

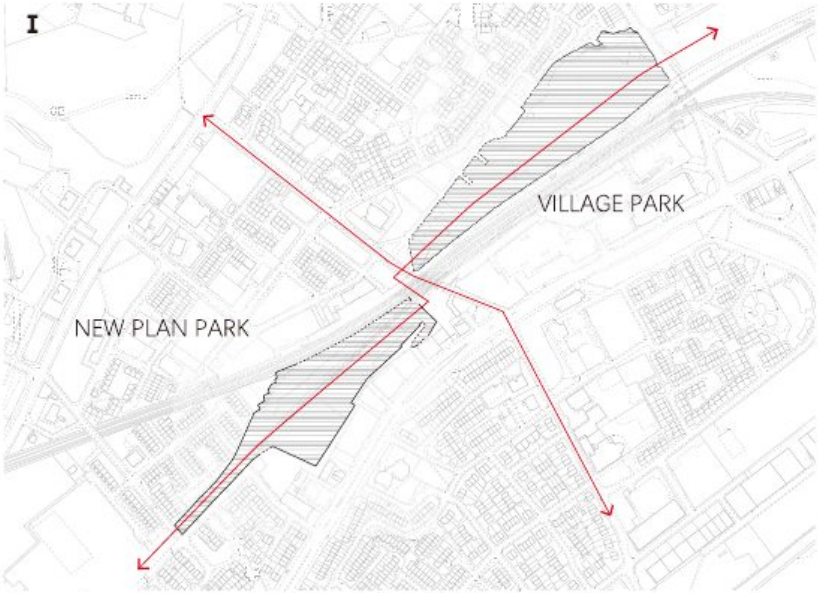


Design Vision Plan

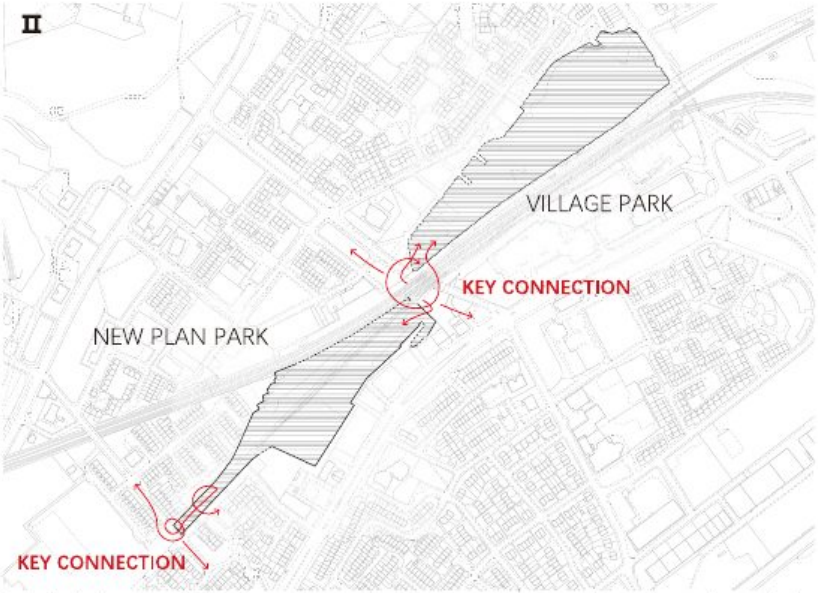
A continuous green corridor reconnecting parks, communities and new housing through landscape-led regeneration.



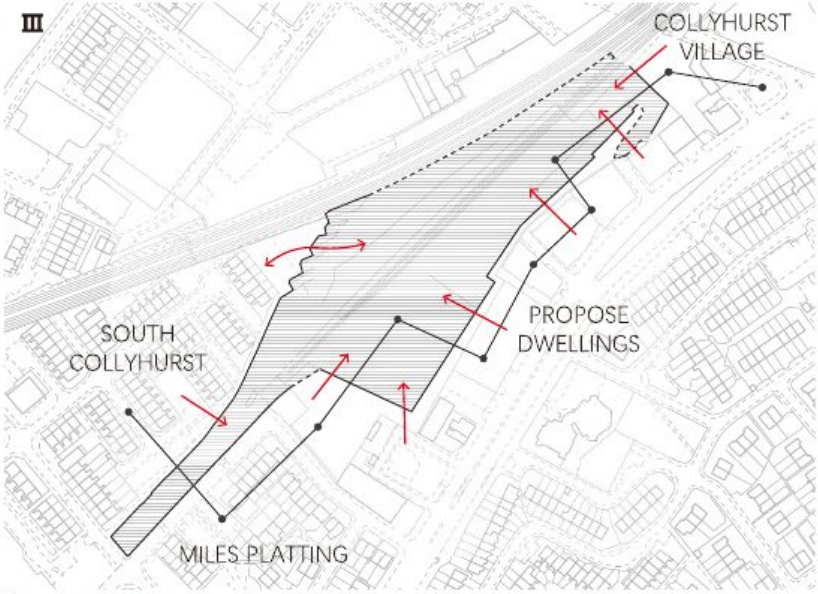
KEY MOVES DIAGRAM



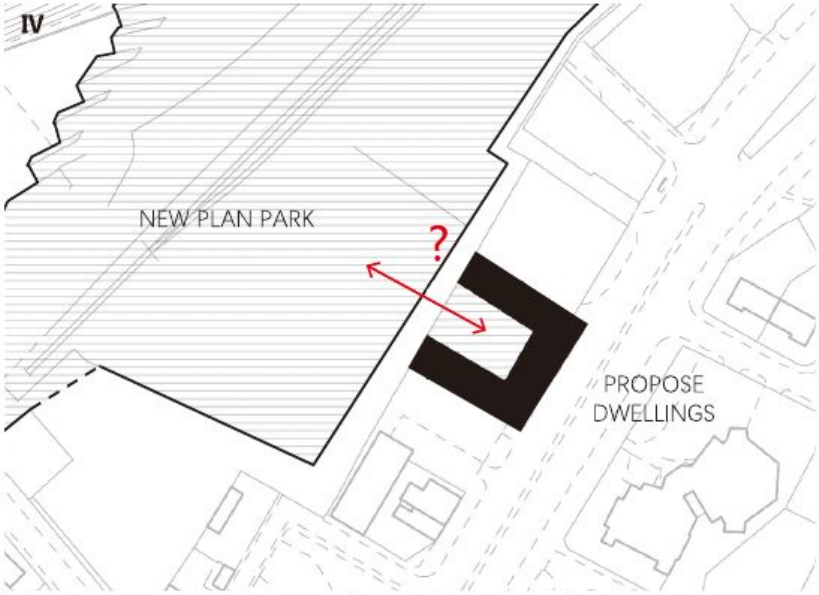
Connecting green spaces and integrating with the surrounding greenery to form a cross-shaped green axis on a regional scale.



Detailed design of the key connection points between the two parks and the neighbourhood.



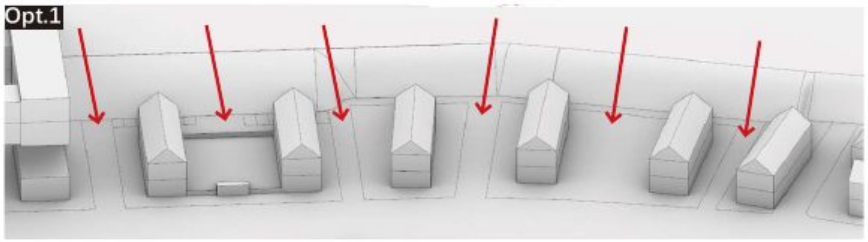
Examine how to strengthen the links between the new park, the surrounding neighbourhoods and the proposed new housing developments.

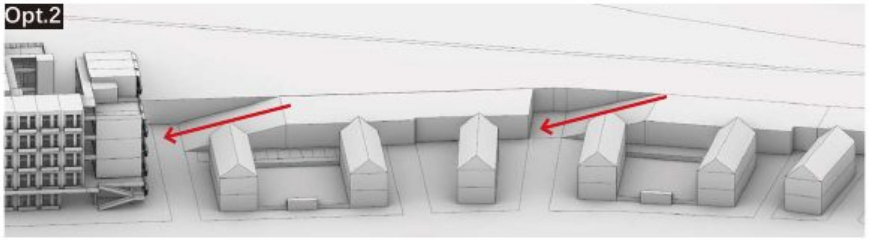


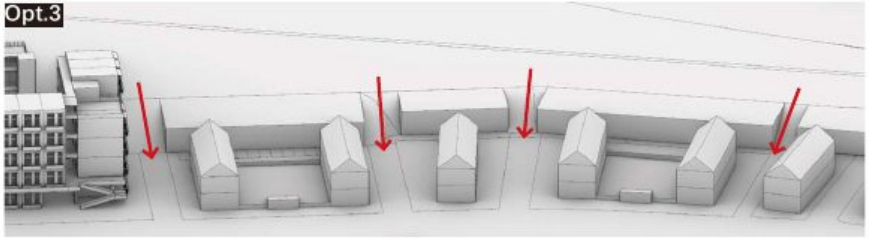
Exploring the connection between private gardens and public parks.

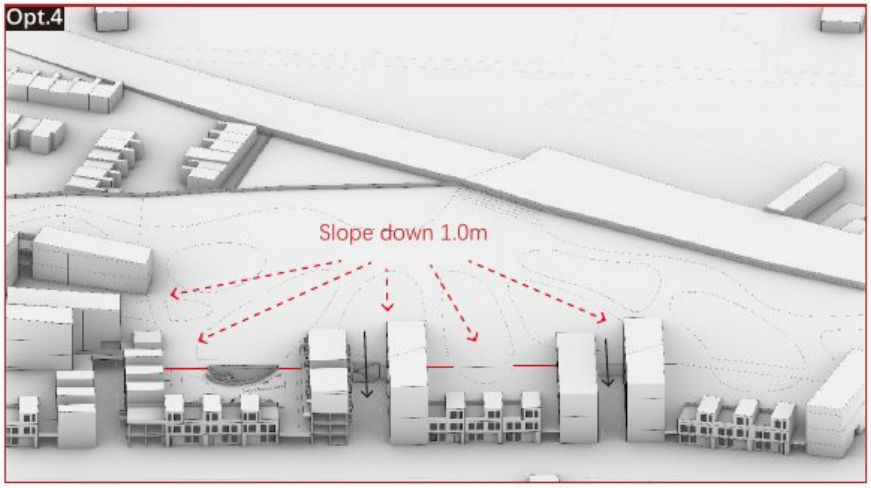
DESIGN CONCEPT

Park Edge Connections

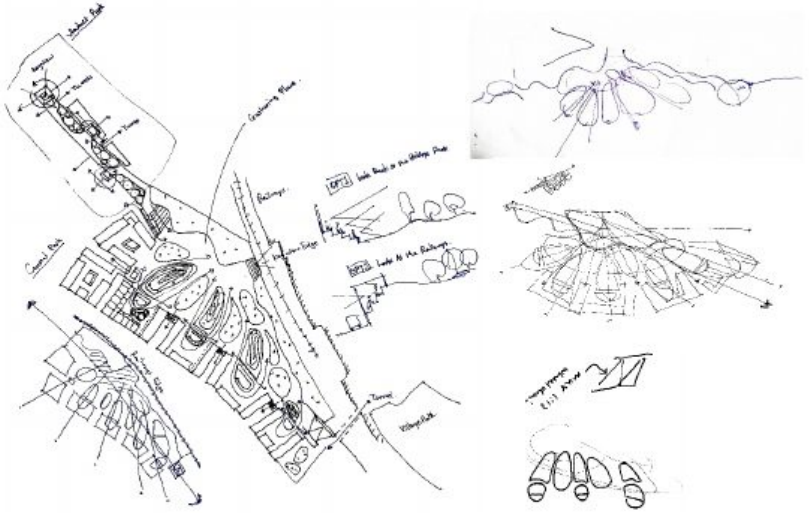




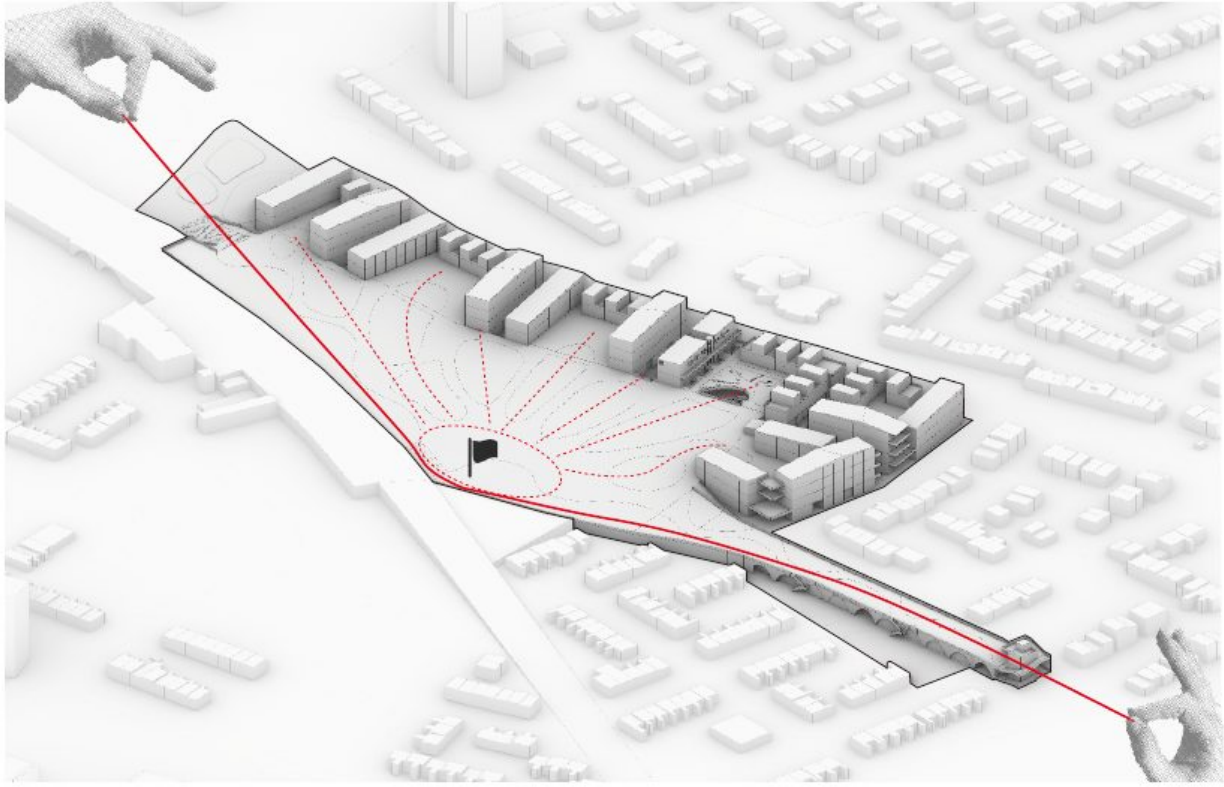




Concept Generation



The proposal is shaped by the idea of a flowing green corridor. Landscape movement, ecological connections and community activities are layered together to generate a series of interconnected green islands that link parks, housing and public spaces. The resulting form creates a continuous landscape experience across South Collyhurst while responding to existing movement patterns and site conditions.



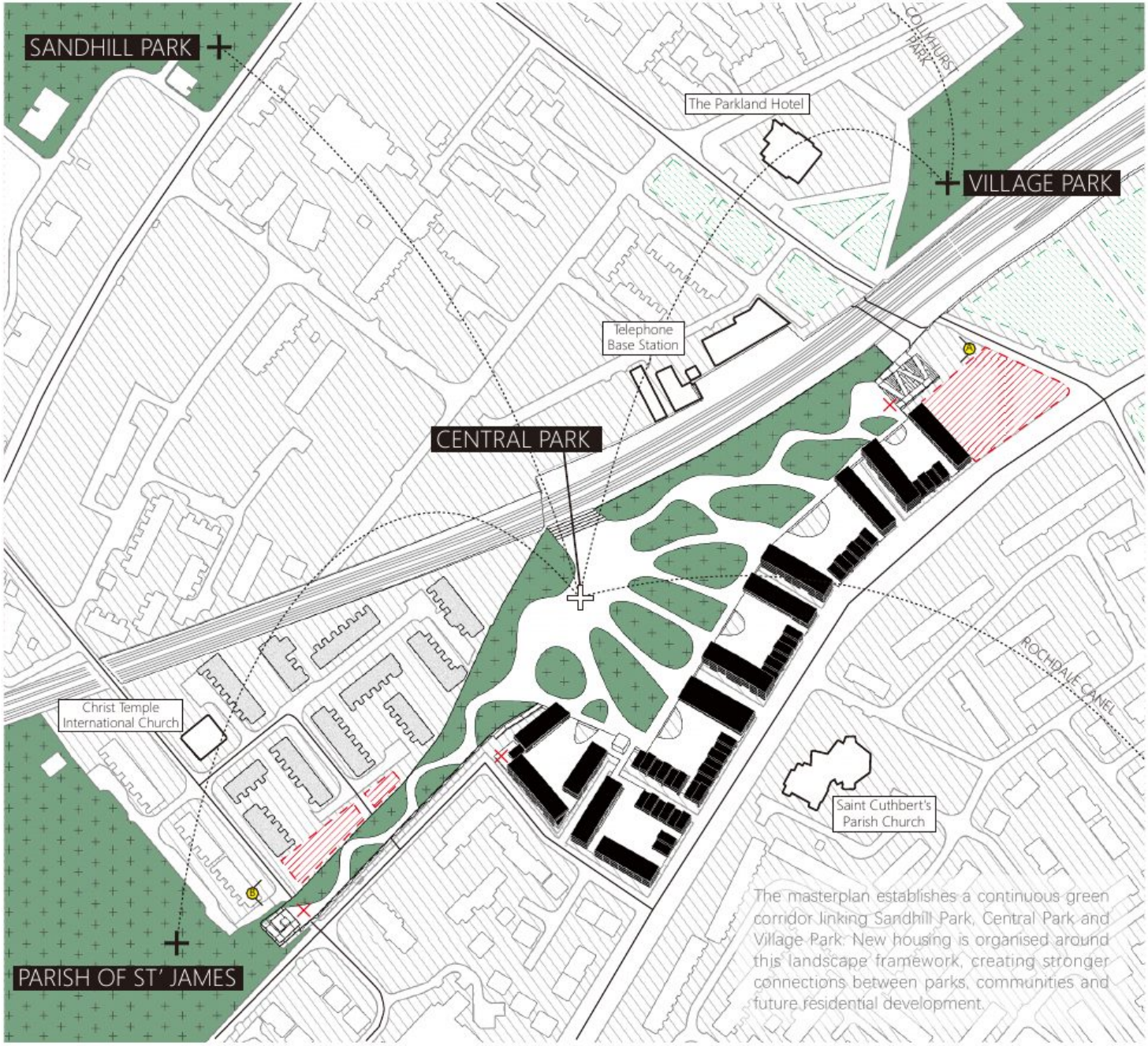
MASTERPLAN OVERVIEW

Figure ground & Site Information



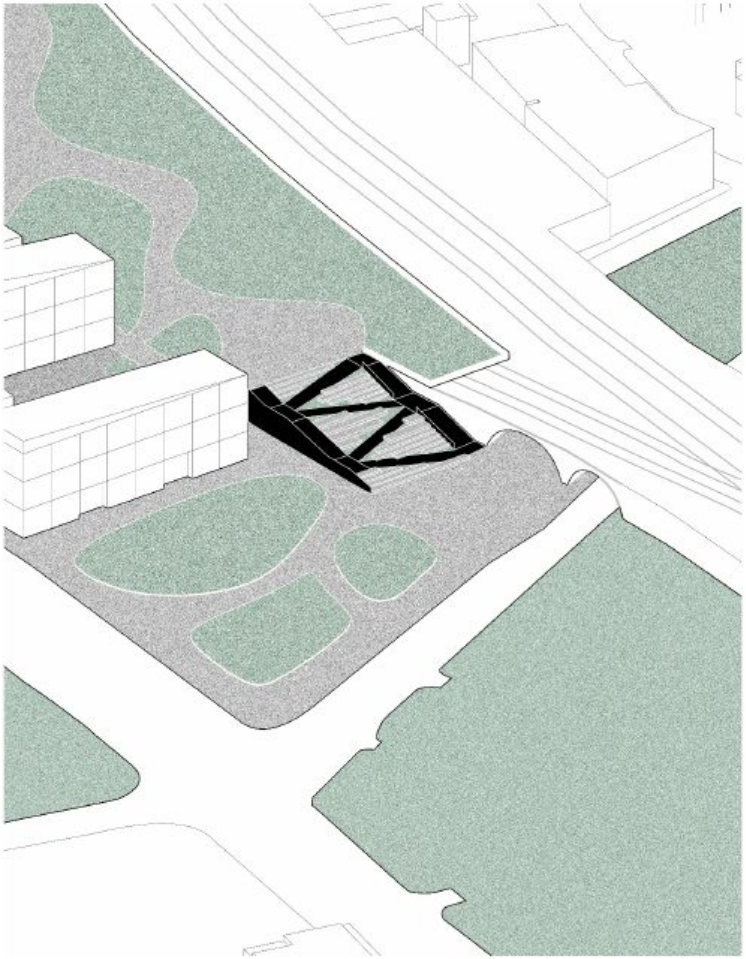
Location	South Collyhurst, Manchester
Designer	Junyu Liao
Client	Academic Design Project
Site Size	Approx. 1.8 ha
No. of Dwellings	189
Density	Approx. 105 dph
Dwelling Mix	Apartments and terrace houses
Other Uses	Community space and active corner uses
Parking Spaces / Home	1.8— underground parking proposed

Materplan



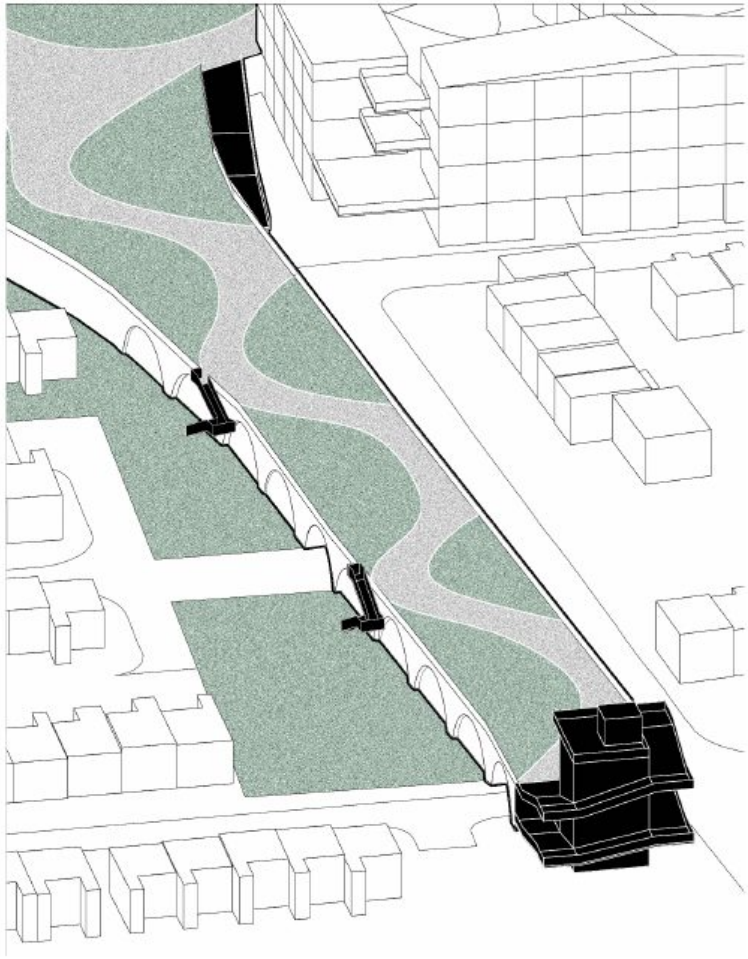
MASTERPLAN OVERVIEW

Key Connection Infrastructure



A

Viaduct Extension Strategy

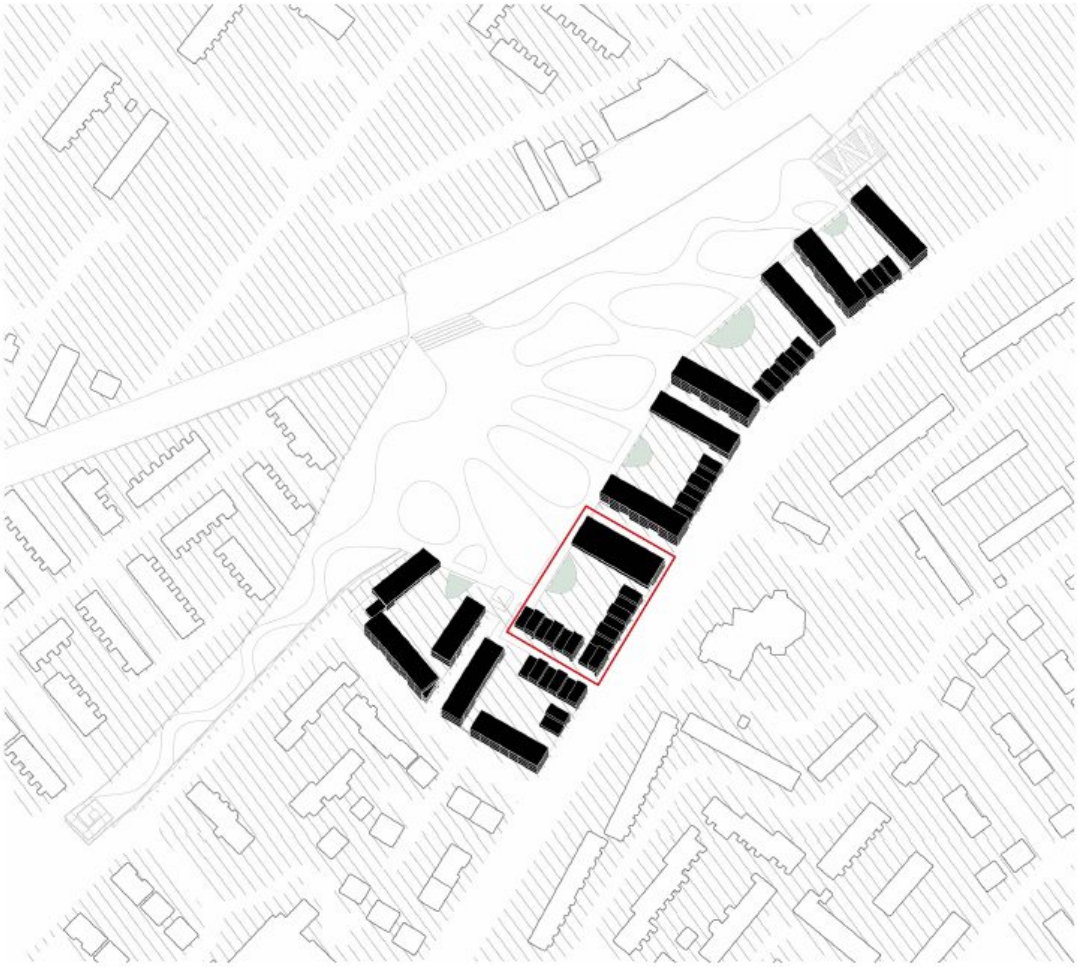


B

03 DESIGN CODE

INTRODUCTION TO DESIGN CODE

Character Block Principle



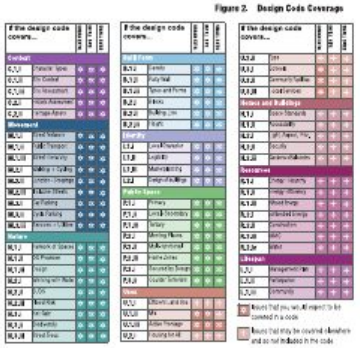
The selected block occupies a strategic position between the green corridor, surrounding neighbourhoods and future development areas. As a key interface between landscape and housing, the block demonstrates how movement, public space and residential living can be integrated through a site-specific design code.

The block is organised around a shared courtyard, active frontages and strong landscape connections, providing a framework for testing design principles at the block, street and building scale.

Design Code Precedent Study

National Model Design Code

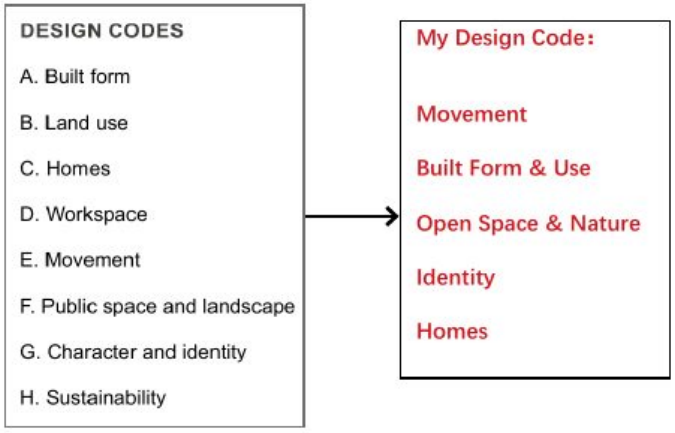




The National Model Design Code (NMDC) provides a framework for creating high-quality, sustainable and locally distinctive places. It establishes design principles that guide the relationship between movement, built form, public space, landscape and housing, ensuring that future development contributes positively to its surrounding context.

This design code adopts the structure and principles of the National Model Design Code and translates them into a site-specific framework for South Collyhurst. The code focuses on five key themes: Movement, Built Form & Use, Open Space & Nature, Identity and Homes, providing guidance for the development of a connected, landscape-led and community-oriented neighbourhood.

MANDELA WAY, OKR2 / OKR3 / OKR4, DESIGN CODE



Based on the structure of the Mandela Way Design Code, the coding framework was adapted and consolidated into five key themes, reflecting the specific spatial, environmental and residential priorities of South Collyhurst.

DESIGN CODE OVERALL

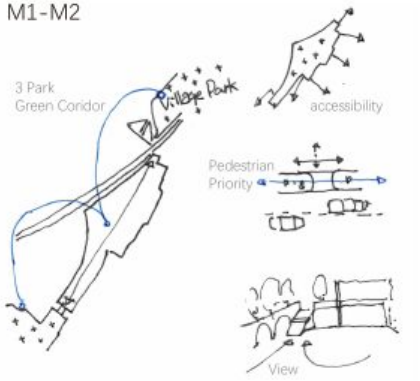
A design code framework that translates the vision of Corridor Living into a set of spatial, environmental and residential principles operating across multiple scales.

Introduction

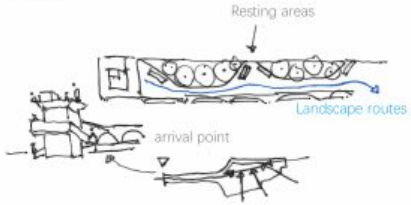
The design code establishes a coherent framework for future development within South Collyhurst. Organised into five themes — Movement, Built Form & Use, Open Space & Nature, Identity, and Homes — the code translates the masterplan vision into a series of design principles that guide movement, landscape, architecture and residential living. Together, these codes create a connected, community-oriented and landscape-led neighbourhood centred around the green corridor.

Movement

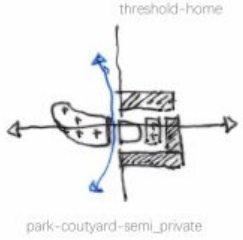
M1-M2



M3-4

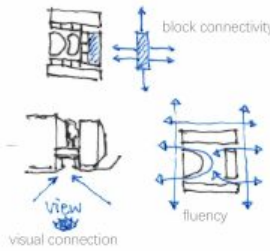


M5-6

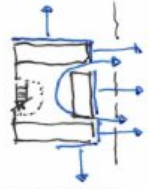


Built Form & Use

BF1-3



BF4



BF5-6

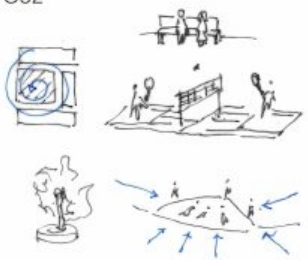


Open Space & Nature

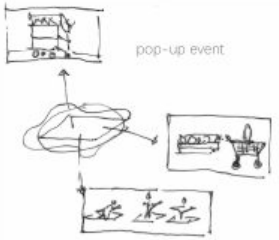
OS1



OS2



OS3

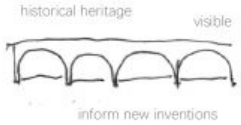


OS4



Identity

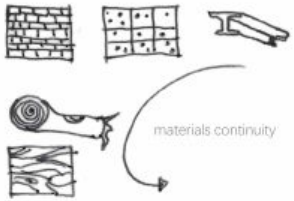
I1



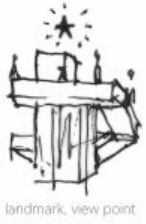
I2



I3-4



I5-6

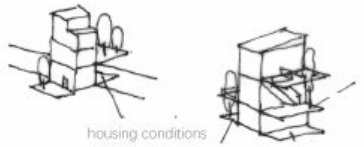


Homes

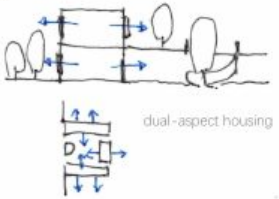
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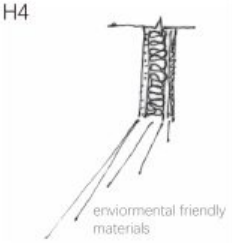
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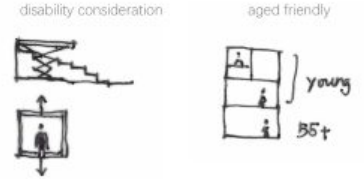
H3



H4



H5



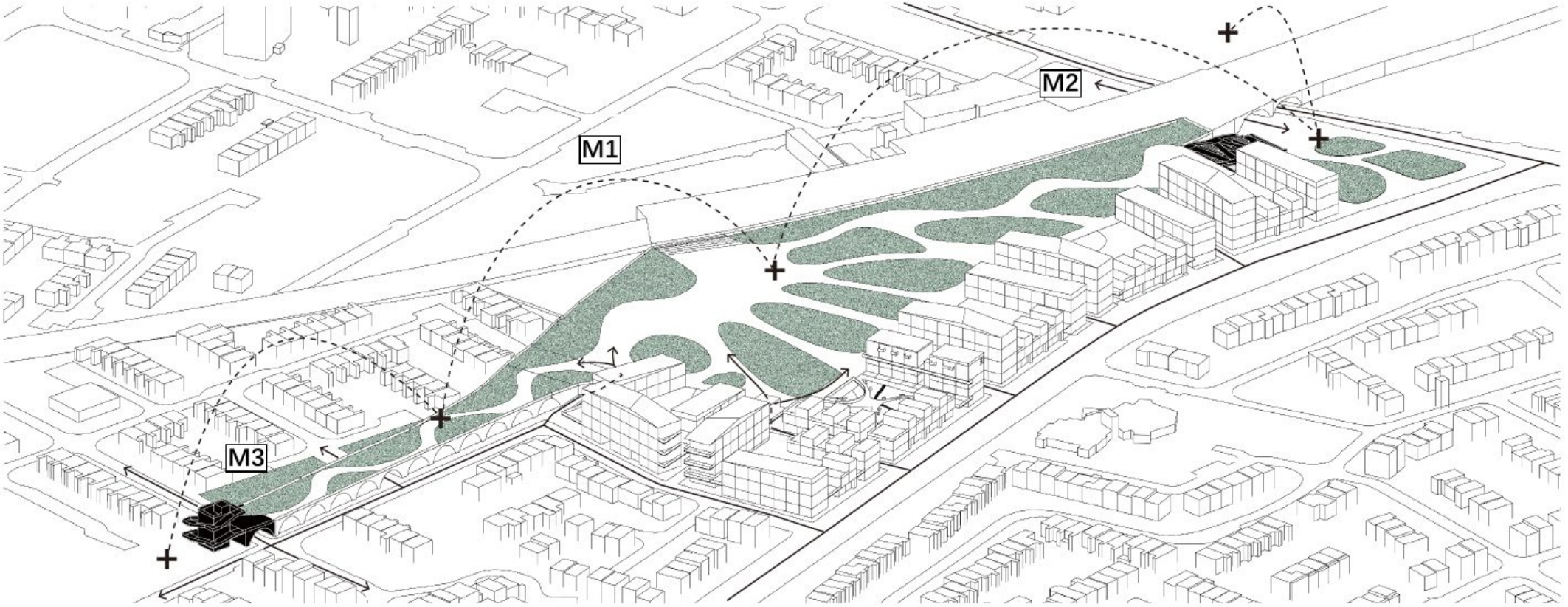
H6



MOVEMENT

Rational Scale

Establishing a connected movement network that links green infrastructure, neighbourhoods and public destinations across South Collyhurst.



M1 Green Corridor Network

The proposed green corridor establishes a continuous landscape connection between Sandhill Park, the new corridor park and Village Park. Rather than functioning as isolated green spaces, these parks form part of a wider ecological and recreational network that extends beyond the site boundary. The corridor improves biodiversity, encourages active travel and strengthens environmental continuity across South Collyhurst.

M2 Strategic North–South Connection

The green corridor acts as a strategic north–south connection linking existing neighbourhoods, future developments and key public open spaces. Movement routes are organised around this landscape spine, allowing residents to travel through the site without relying on vehicular infrastructure. The corridor becomes a primary organising element for future growth and community interaction.

M3 Bridge as Regional Gateway

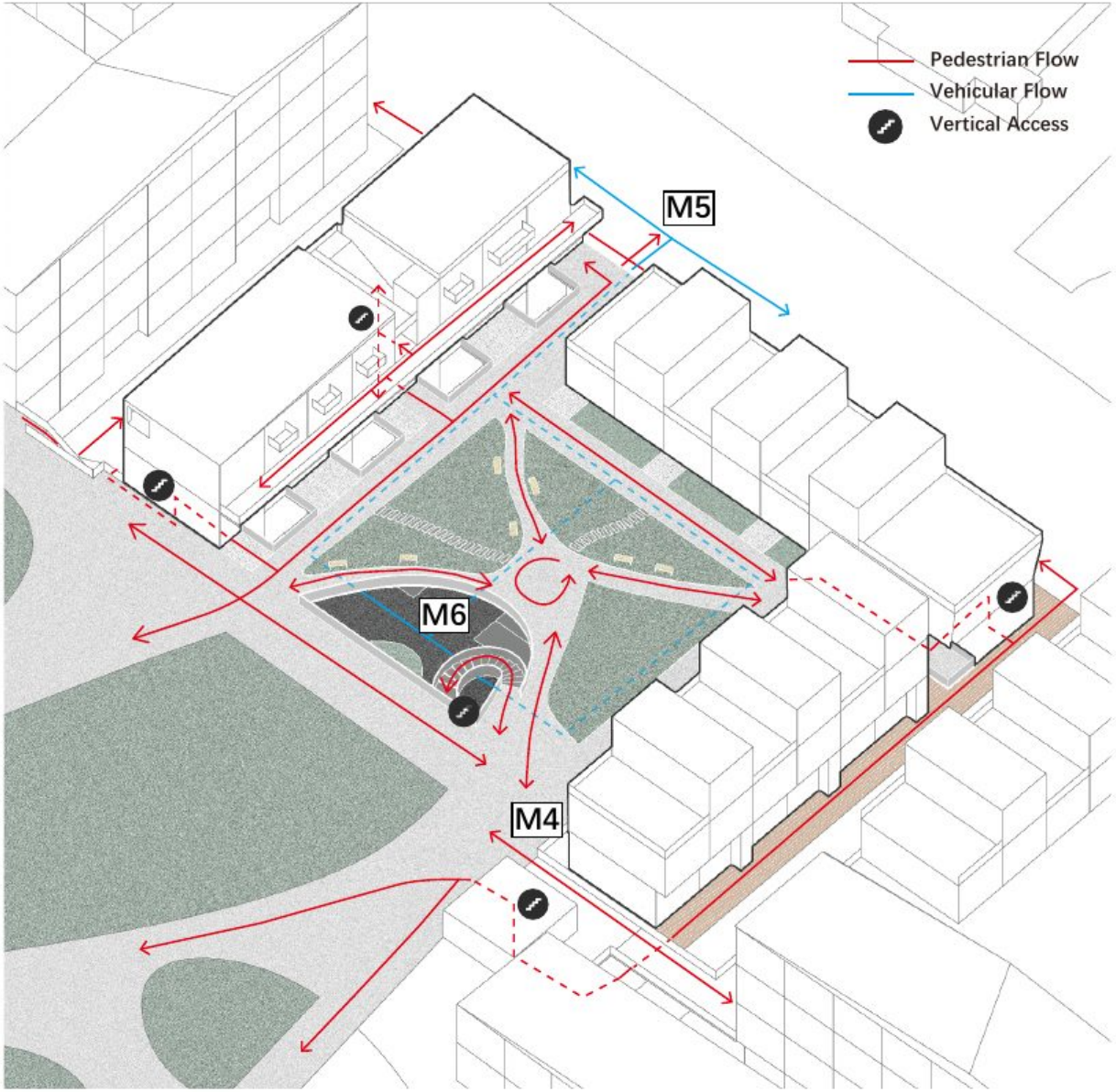
The bridge crossing is reimagined as a public destination rather than solely a piece of transport infrastructure. New viewing platforms and enhanced pedestrian routes transform the bridge into a landmark that connects both sides of the railway while providing visual access to the wider green corridor. The intervention reinforces the identity of the site and strengthens regional connectivity.

MOVEMENT

Block Scale

Movement within the block prioritises pedestrians by creating direct and accessible connections between streets, courtyards and public open spaces. Routes are designed to strengthen everyday interaction while maintaining a clear transition from public landscape to private residential areas.

Circulation Analysis



M4 Neighbourhood Connections

Movement routes should strengthen relationships between the proposed development and surrounding residential neighbourhoods. Key access points are positioned to maximise permeability and encourage movement between existing communities, new housing and public open spaces. Routes should remain direct, legible and safe for all users.

M5 Pedestrian Priority

Pedestrian movement should take priority over vehicle circulation throughout the development. Streets, shared spaces and park connections should be designed to encourage walking and cycling while minimising barriers created by cars. Routes should provide clear access to public spaces, residential entrances and community facilities.

M6 Park-to-Home Sequence

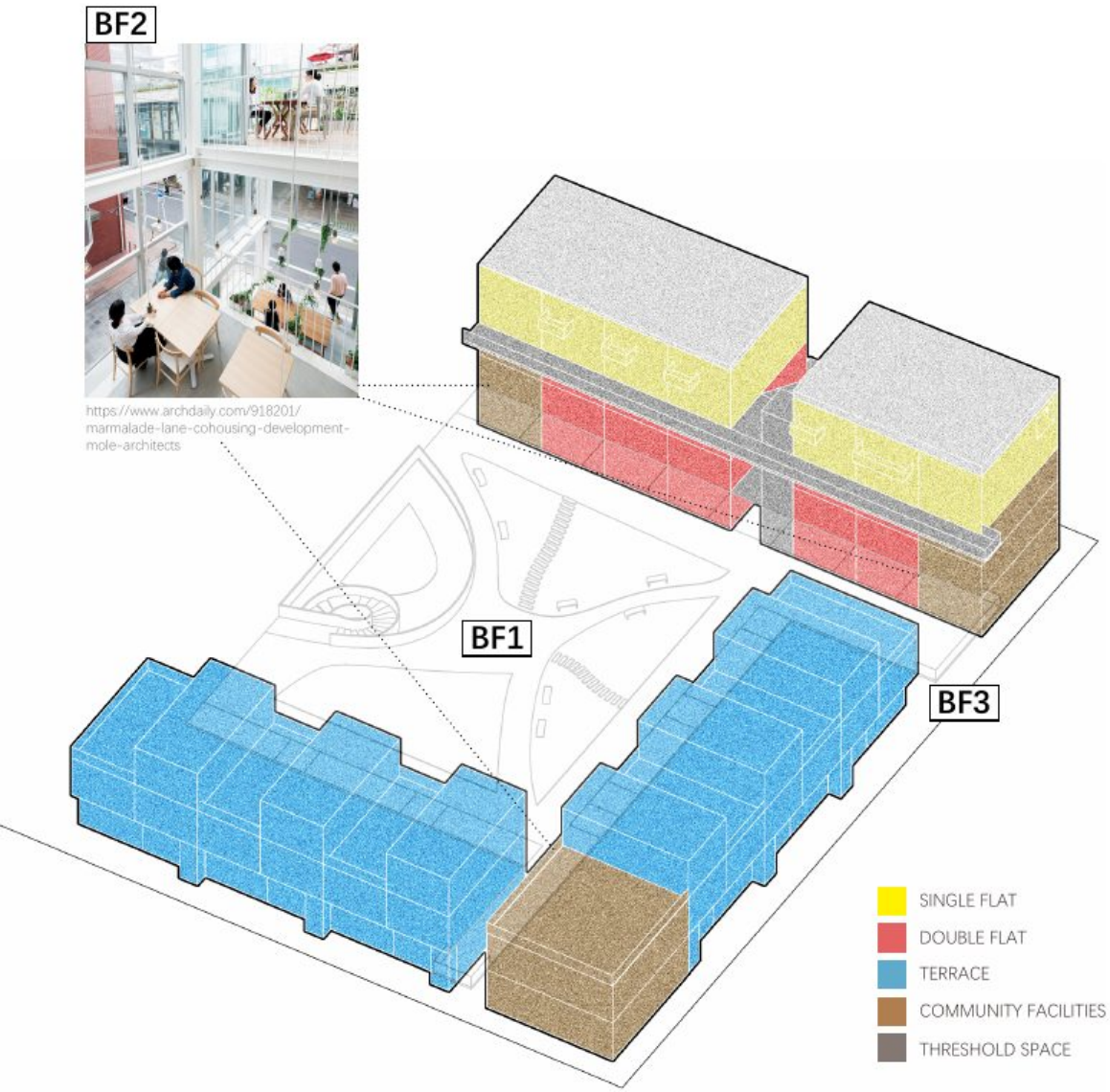
Movement should support a gradual transition from public landscape to private dwelling. Residents should experience a clear spatial sequence from park, to courtyard, to entrance threshold and finally to home. This hierarchy helps create a strong relationship between landscape and everyday living while maintaining privacy and residential amenity.

BUILTFORM & USE

Introduction

The built form strategy defines how buildings shape movement, public space and community activity. Building massing, edge conditions and active uses work together to create a connected and socially engaged neighbourhood block.

Functional Diagram



BF1 Connector Block

The block should act as a spatial connector between the green corridor, surrounding neighbourhoods and public open spaces. Building massing should reinforce movement routes while maintaining visual and physical connections to the wider landscape network. The built form should support permeability rather than create barriers within the site.

BF2 Active Corner

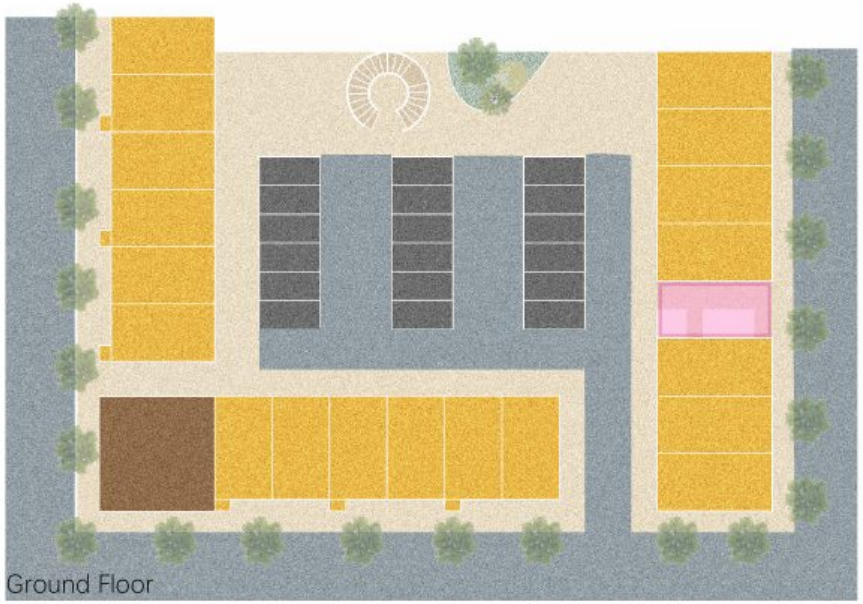
Key corners should become social destinations that encourage interaction and community activity. Community facilities, cafés, workshops or flexible neighbourhood uses should be positioned at prominent locations to activate the public realm and strengthen local identity.

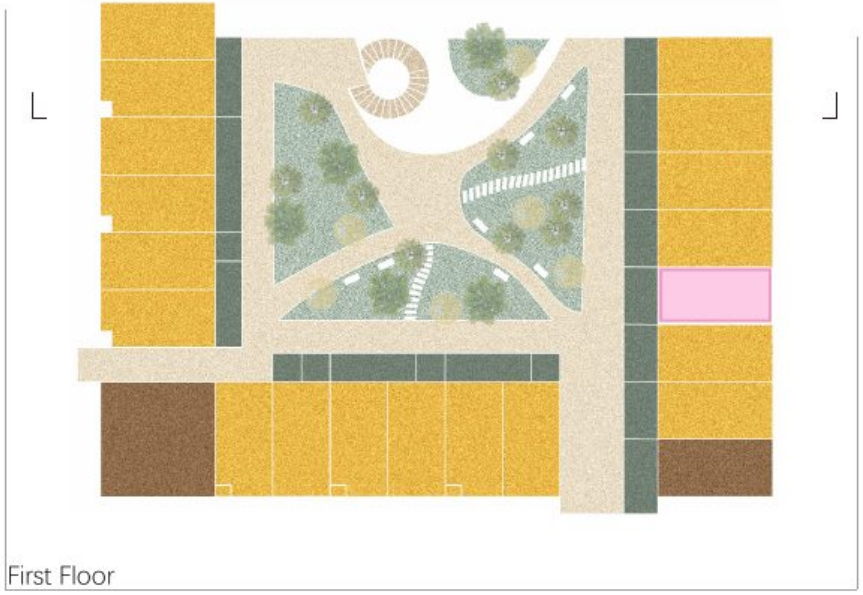
BF3 Active Ground Floor

Ground floor frontages should contribute to the life of the street and courtyard. Entrances, shared facilities and active uses should create visual engagement with public space, helping to improve safety, accessibility and social interaction throughout the development.

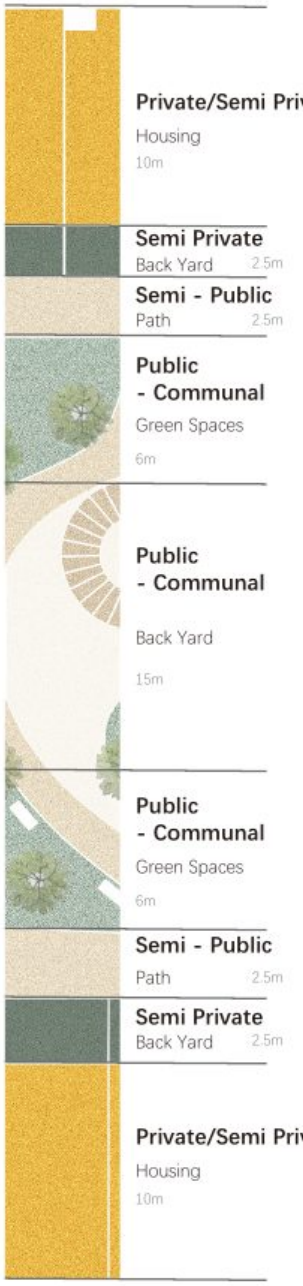
BUILTFORM & USE

Spatial Hierarchy Diagram





Private
Semi - Public
Semi Private - Communal
Public
Semi-Private
Public - Communal



BF4 Courtyard Block Form

Buildings should be arranged to define a shared courtyard that acts as the social heart of the block. The form should provide enclosure and a sense of place while ensuring access to daylight, views and direct connections to surrounding landscape spaces.

BF5 Edge Conditions

Different building edges should respond to different spatial conditions. Street-facing edges should create an active urban frontage, courtyard-facing edges should encourage community interaction, and park-facing edges should maximise access to landscape and open views.

BF6 Mixed Community Uses

Small-scale community uses should be integrated within the residential block to support everyday neighbourhood life. Flexible spaces located along movement routes and key public areas should provide opportunities for gathering, working, learning and informal social interaction.

OPEN SPACE & NATURE

Collyhurst Existing Landscape

The site contains a diverse landscape structure composed of mature trees, shrubs and grassland species. Existing vegetation should be retained where possible and incorporated into the proposed green corridor to support biodiversity, strengthen ecological connectivity and enhance the character of South Collyhurst.



Landscape Precedent Study

Marmalade Lane Cohousing Development / Mole Architects



Trees, front gardens and shared planting are integrated throughout the courtyard to strengthen community interaction and create a landscape-led living environment.

https://www.archdaily.com/918201/marmalade-lane-cohousing-development-mole-architects

OS1 Green Corridor Network

The green corridor forms the primary landscape structure of the masterplan, connecting existing and proposed green spaces while supporting ecological continuity, pedestrian movement and recreational activity across South Collyhurst.

OS2 Shared Courtyard Garden

Shared courtyards should function as the social heart of each residential block, providing opportunities for gathering, play, relaxation and everyday interaction within a safe and accessible green environment.

OS3 Community Activity Spaces

Public open spaces should accommodate a range of flexible activities, including markets, informal events, outdoor recreation and neighbourhood gatherings, supporting a vibrant and inclusive community.

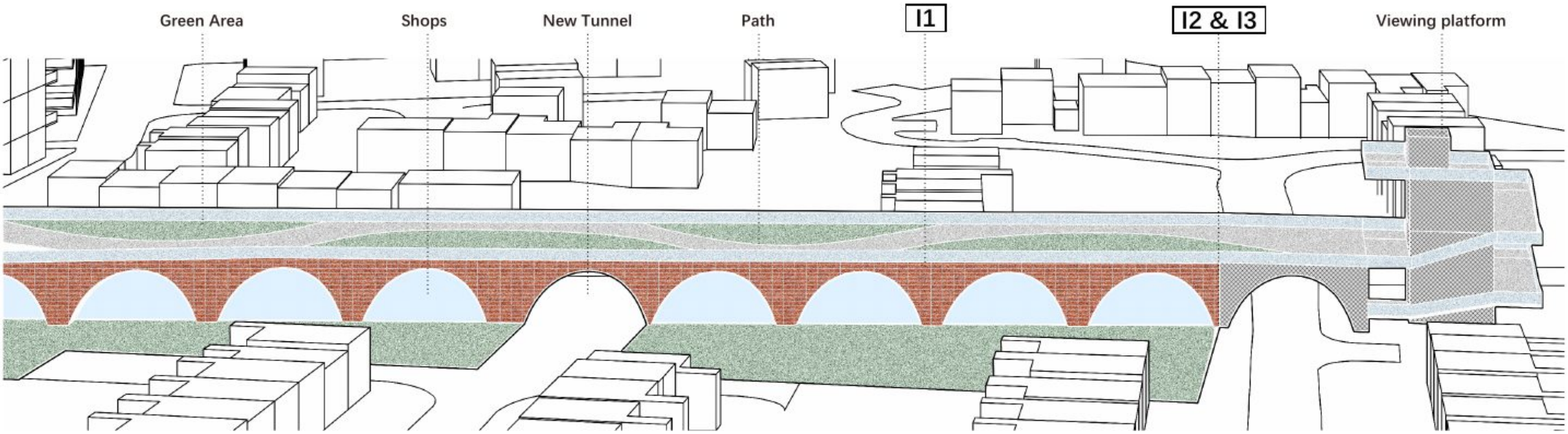
OS4 Green Fingers

Smaller landscape connections should extend from the main corridor into residential blocks, strengthening visual and physical links between homes, courtyards and the wider green network.

IDENTITY

Identity Introduction

The identity strategy seeks to preserve the industrial heritage of Collyhurst while establishing a contemporary architectural language for future development. Through the retention of the historic railway viaduct, the use of locally rooted materials and the integration of new interventions, the proposal creates a dialogue between past and future, reinforcing a distinctive sense of place.



I1 Infrastructure Memory

The existing railway viaduct forms one of the most significant historical elements within the site and should remain a visible part of the future neighbourhood. Rather than concealing or removing the structure, new interventions should reinforce its presence and transform it into an active component of the public realm. The viaduct should act as both a physical landmark and a reminder of Collyhurst's industrial heritage.

I2 Old and New Dialogue

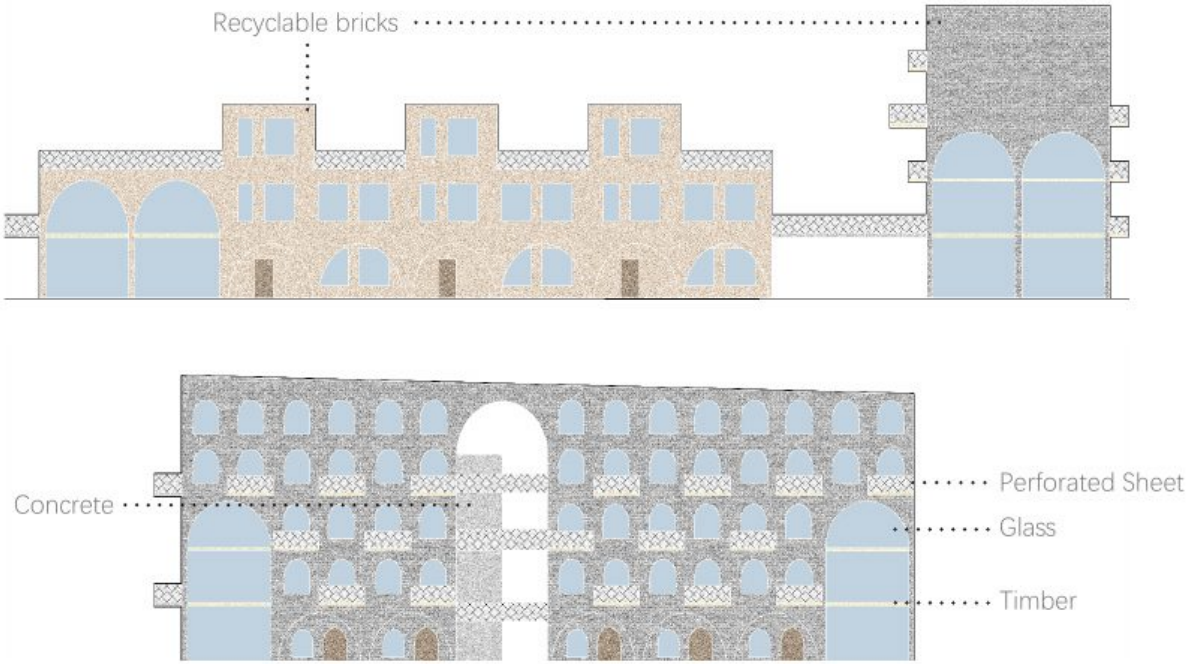
New architectural interventions should establish a clear relationship with the existing viaduct while remaining identifiable as contemporary additions. New structures should complement the scale, rhythm and character of the historic infrastructure without replicating it. The contrast between historic brick construction and lightweight contemporary structures should create a legible dialogue between old and new.

I3 Material Transition

Material selection should express the transition between industrial infrastructure, public landscape and residential development. Existing brick and concrete elements should be retained where possible, while new interventions should utilise durable contemporary materials such as weathering steel, timber and steel mesh structures. Material changes should clearly communicate shifts between heritage assets and new architectural additions.

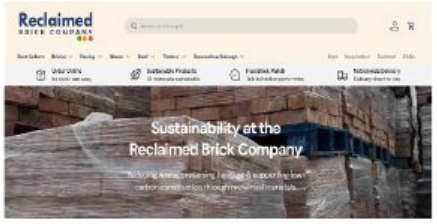
IDENTITY

Block Facade



Sastainable Material Precedent Study

Reclaimed Brick Company





Reclaimed brick reduces embodied carbon by reusing existing materials rather than manufacturing new products. Its durability and potential for future reuse support a circular and sustainable approach to residential construction.

https://reclaimedbrickcompany.co.uk/pages/sustainability

I4 Brick Housing Character

Brick should be the primary material used throughout residential buildings, reflecting the historic character of Collyhurst and the wider architectural language of Manchester. The consistent use of brick provides continuity, durability and a timeless residential identity. Variations in texture, tone and detailing may be used to distinguish different housing types while maintaining a coherent architectural language across the development.

I5 Architectural Language and Identity

The arch should be reinterpreted as a contemporary design language inspired by the historic viaduct. It may be introduced at ground floors, corner buildings and key public interfaces to reinforce local identity and improve visual continuity. Beyond architecture, this language can be extended to landscape structures, entrances, signage, lighting and public furniture, creating a consistent and recognisable identity throughout the neighbourhood.

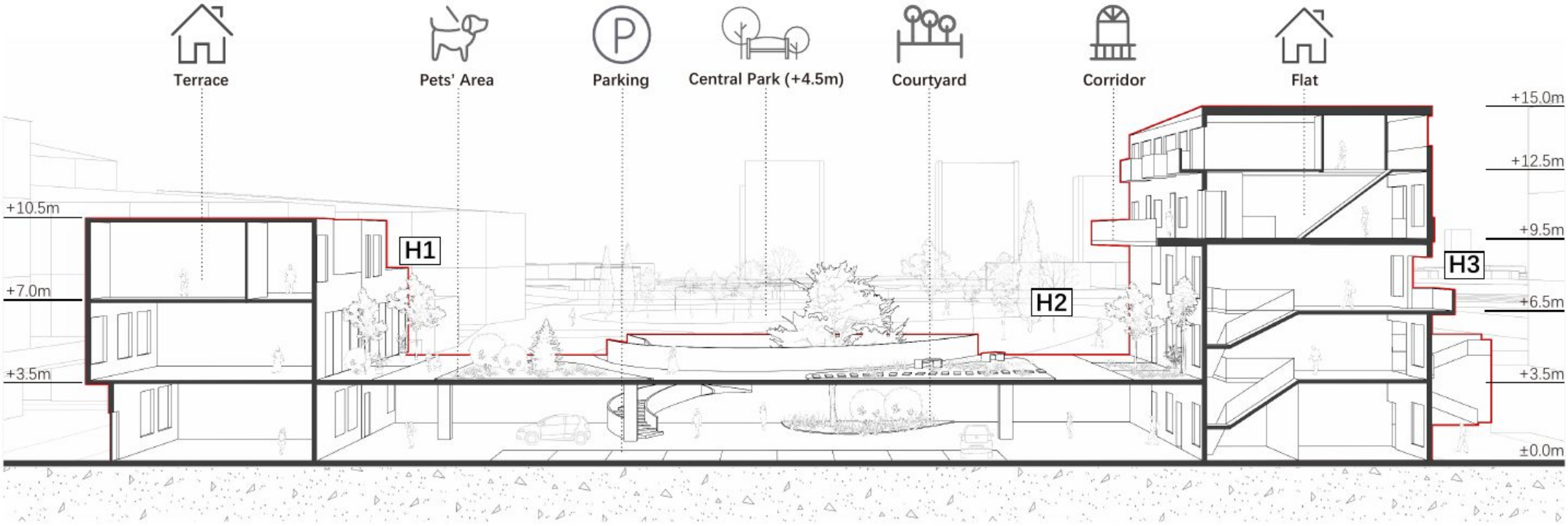
I6 Green Residential Identity

Landscape should become an integral part of the architectural identity of the development. Balconies, external galleries and shared residential spaces should incorporate planting and vertical greenery to extend the green corridor into the building fabric. Continuous planting strategies should strengthen visual connections between homes, courtyards and public parks, creating a distinctive residential character rooted in nature, community living and environmental sustainability.

HOMES

Introduction

The housing strategy promotes healthy, community-oriented and nature-connected living environments. Homes are organised around shared courtyards, green thresholds and flexible housing typologies, while sustainable materials and construction systems contribute to long-term environmental performance.



H1 Green Living Sequence

Residents should experience a continuous relationship with landscape throughout the home. A clear spatial sequence should connect public parks, shared courtyards, private gardens and internal living spaces, ensuring that nature becomes part of everyday residential life.

H2 Split-Level Courtyard Relationship

The housing section should strengthen connections between different landscape levels. Ground floor dwellings should connect directly to private front gardens and parking areas, while upper levels should overlook shared courtyards and communal green spaces. This arrangement creates multiple opportunities for interaction between residents and landscape.

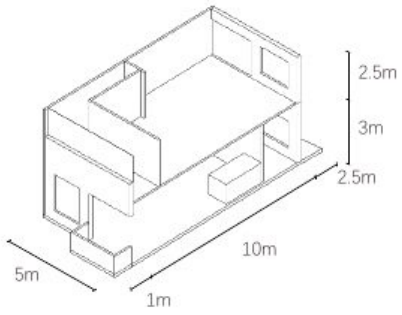
H3 Green Gallery Living

External galleries and balconies should function as social and ecological spaces rather than circulation corridors. Planting, vertical greenery and shared landscape elements should be integrated into access galleries to create opportunities for informal interaction and strengthen connections between neighbouring households.

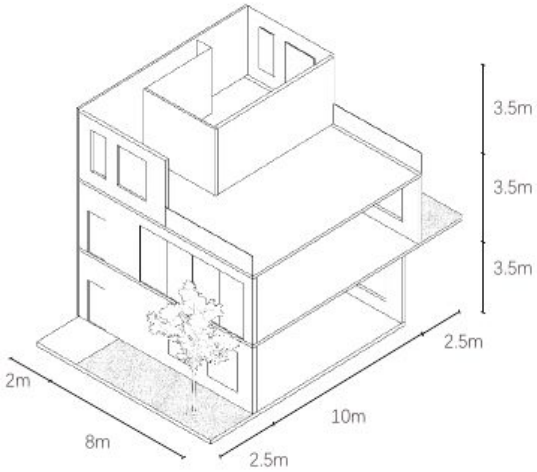
HOMES

Housing Typology

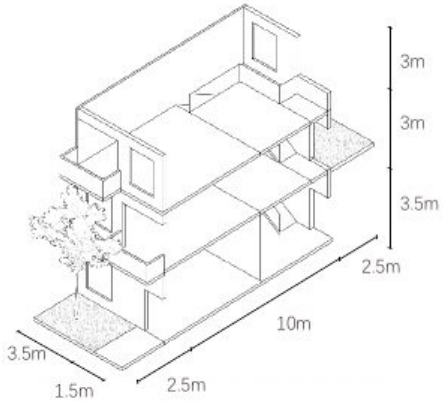
1-Bedroom Flat



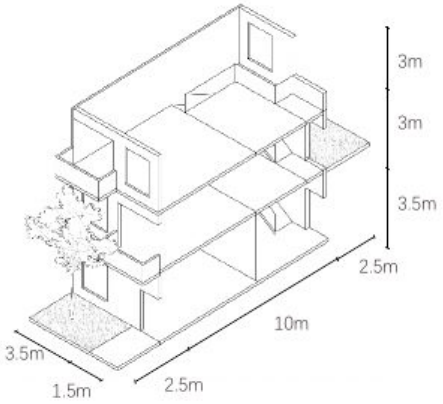
3/4-Bedroom Terrace



2-Bedroom Flat



3-Storage Studio



H4 Apartment Typology

Apartment units should provide compact and efficient living spaces for individuals and couples while maintaining strong connections to landscape and natural light.

All apartments should incorporate dual-aspect openings where possible and maintain visual connections to both street-side and courtyard-side landscape.

Apartment

5m × 10m

1 Bedroom

Ground Floor 3.5m

Upper Floor 2.5–3.0m

H5 Terrace Typology

Terrace housing should accommodate family living through larger floorplates and direct access to shared and private outdoor space.

Terrace homes should provide strong relationships with private gardens, shared courtyards and surrounding green infrastructure.

Terrace House

10m × 10m

2 Bedrooms

Ground Floor 3.5m

Upper Floors 3.0m

H6 Housing Diversity

A mix of apartment and terrace typologies should be provided to accommodate different household structures and life stages. Housing diversity contributes to a balanced community while supporting a range of living preferences and residential needs.

Apartments——Individuals / Couples

Terraces——Families

Residential Building Material Precedent Study

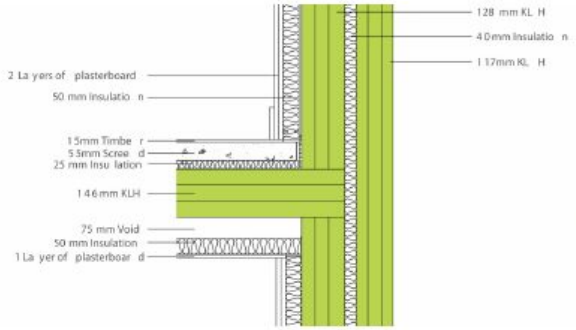
Murray Grove / Stadthaus

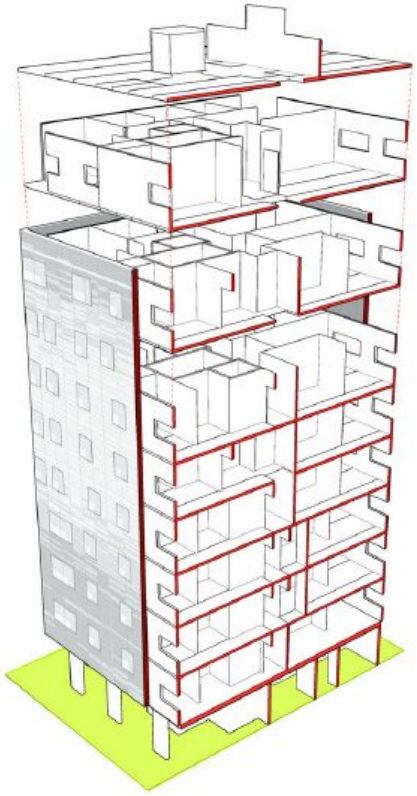


Murray Grove (Stadthaus) employs a predominantly timber construction system, using prefabricated cross-laminated timber panels as the primary structural elements. The extensive use of timber significantly reduces embodied carbon while providing a lightweight and efficient construction method.

Externally, durable façade materials are combined with the timber structure to ensure longevity and weather protection, while internally exposed timber surfaces create a warm and natural living environment.

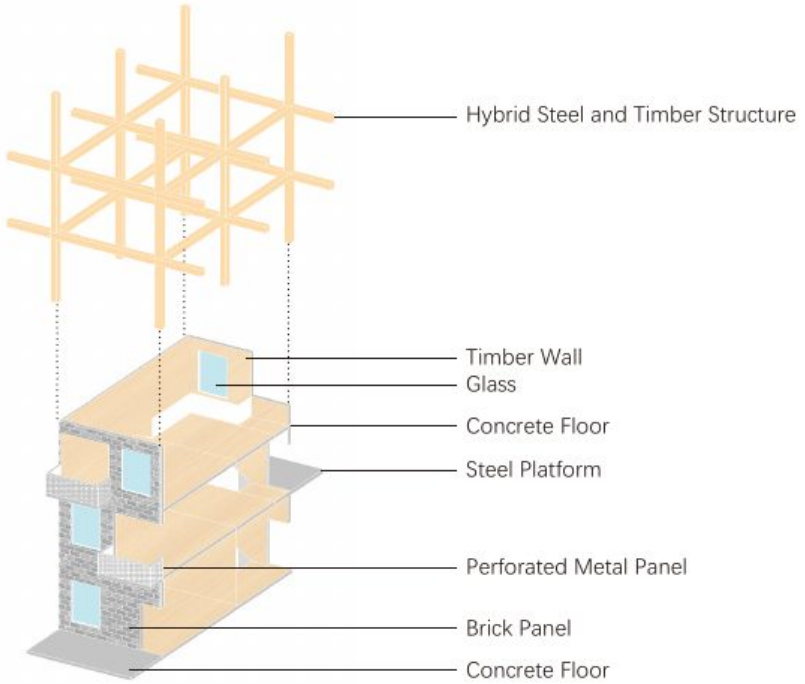






https://www.archdaily.com/es/02-22097/stadthaus-24-murray-grove-waugh-thistleton-architects

Construction and Material Strategy



H7 Brick and Timber Material Palette

The material palette should combine the permanence of brick with the warmth of timber. Brick provides continuity with the historic character of Collyhurst, while timber contributes to a healthy and sustainable residential environment.

H8 Nature-Based Residential Design

Planting and natural materials should be integrated throughout residential buildings to strengthen wellbeing and environmental performance. Balconies, galleries and communal spaces should incorporate greenery to create a consistent relationship between architecture and landscape.

04 DESIGN PROPOSITION

SECTIONAL MODEL 1:200





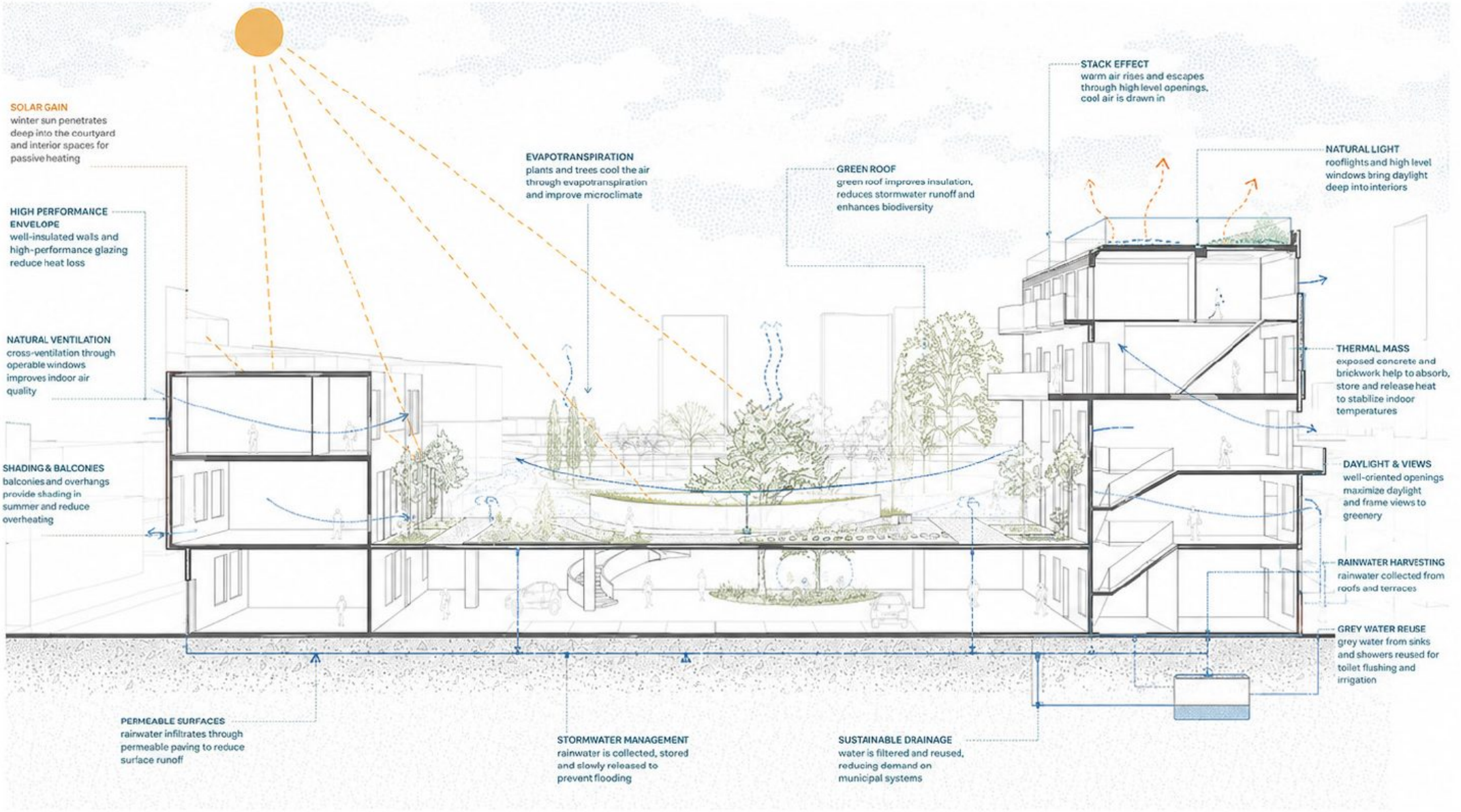




RESIDENTIAL COMFORT ANALYSIS

Environmental & Sustainability Analysis

The residential environment integrates passive design strategies with green infrastructure to improve everyday comfort and environmental performance. Natural ventilation, daylight and solar gain are supported by the open courtyard layout, while planting, green roofs and permeable landscape help regulate microclimate and manage rainwater. These strategies create a healthier and more sustainable relationship between the homes and their shared landscape.



RESIDENTIAL COMFORT ANALYSIS

Solar Analysis

Annual Sun Path: NE → SE at sunrise, and SW → NW at sunset.





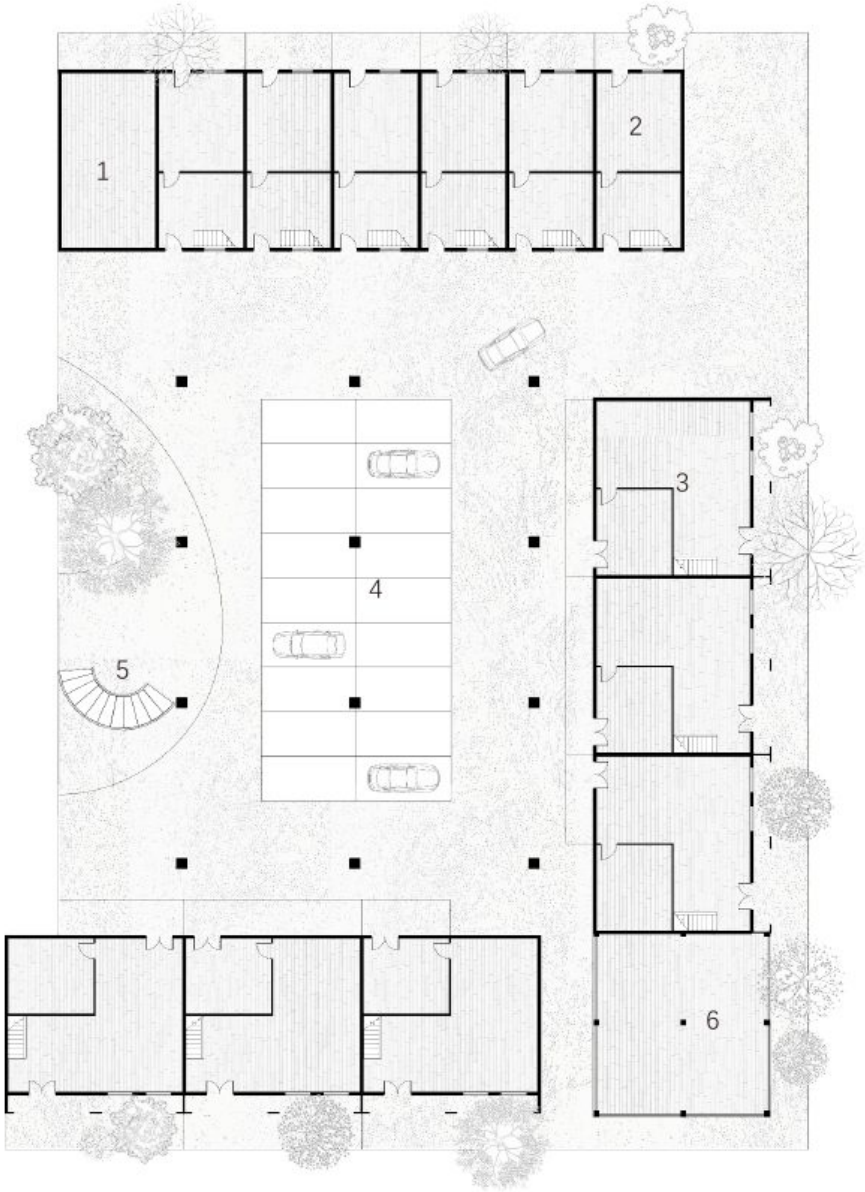


Block Overview

The block is organised around a central shared courtyard, creating a direct relationship between housing, landscape and communal space. Apartments and terrace houses define the edges while maintaining visual and pedestrian connections towards the surrounding park. The stepped building heights and open layout allow daylight, ventilation and greenery to extend into the residential environment, supporting a more comfortable and connected form of courtyard living.



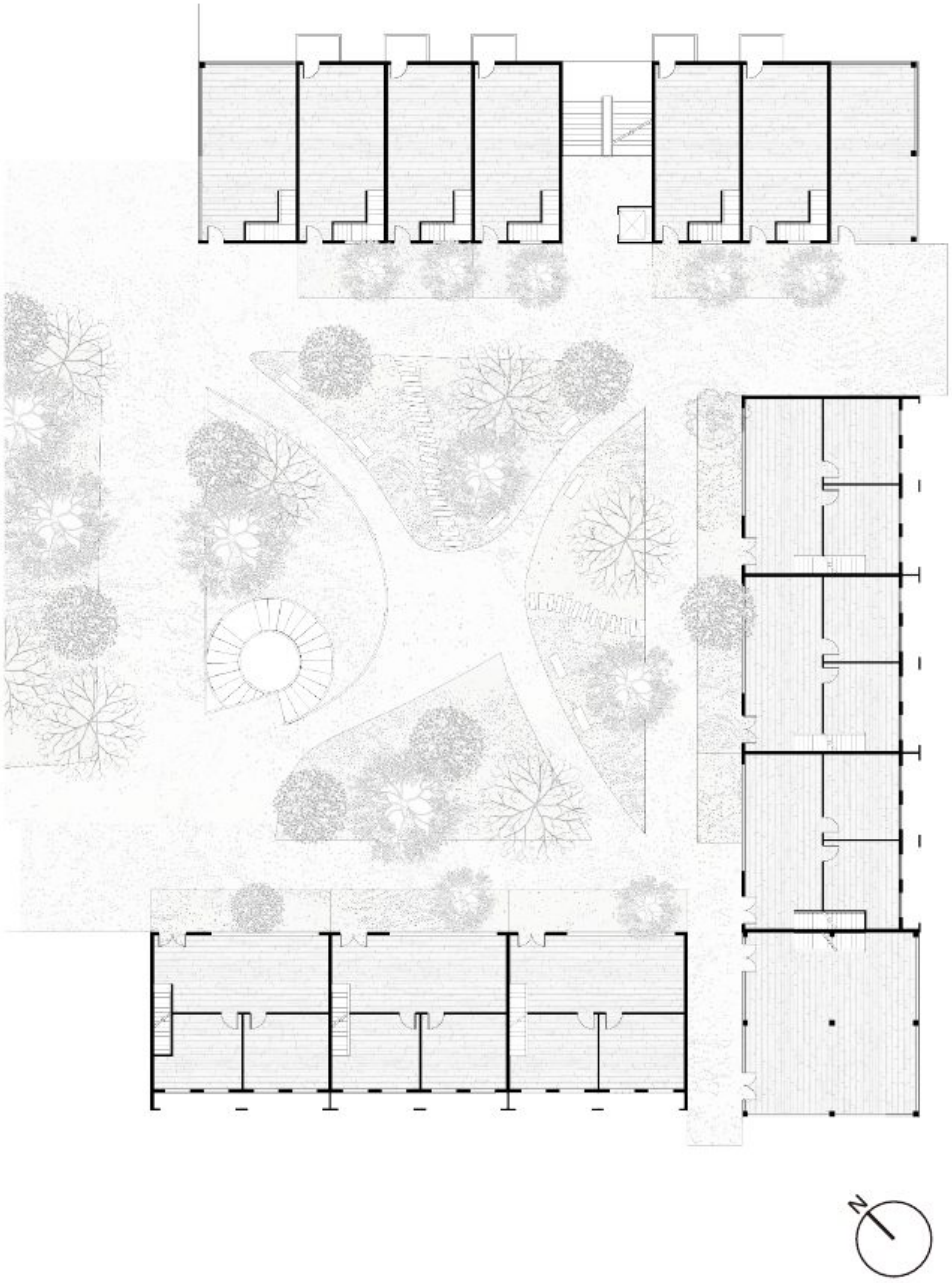
GROUND FLOOR PLAN, 1:300



1 Community Use
2 Double Flat
3 Terrace House
4 Parking Spaces
5 Threshold Space
6 Coffee Shop



FIRST FLOOR PLAN, 1:300

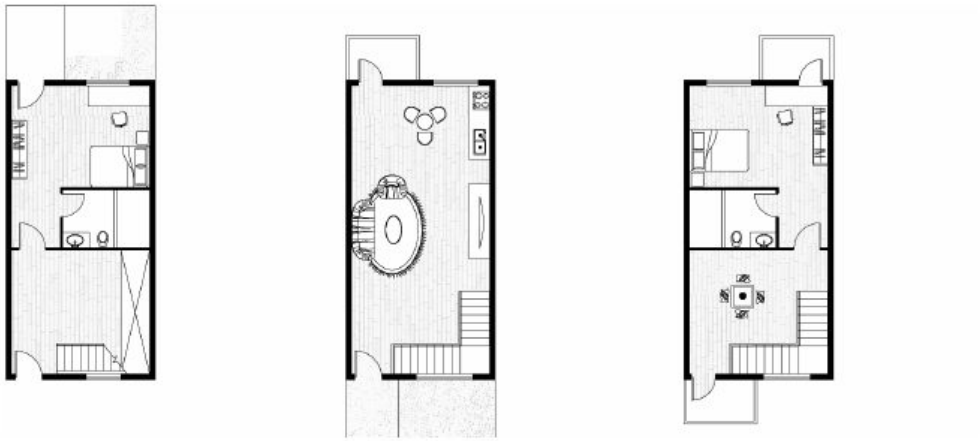






TYPICAL UNIT PLANS, 1:200

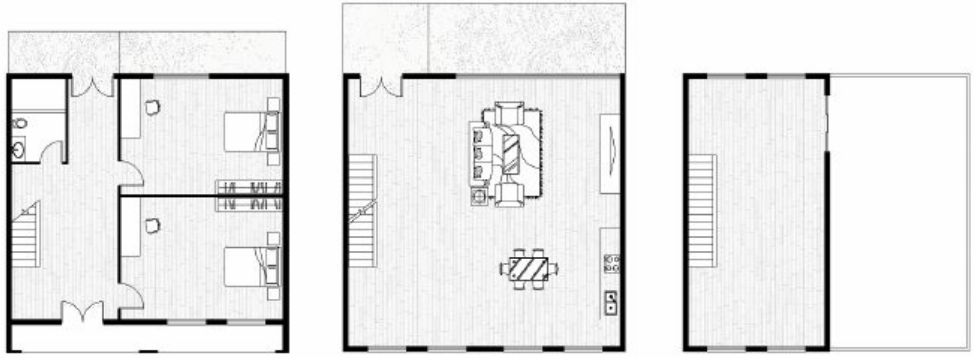
Type A — 2-Bed Shared Apartment



Type B — Single-Person Loft



Type C — Family Terrace House

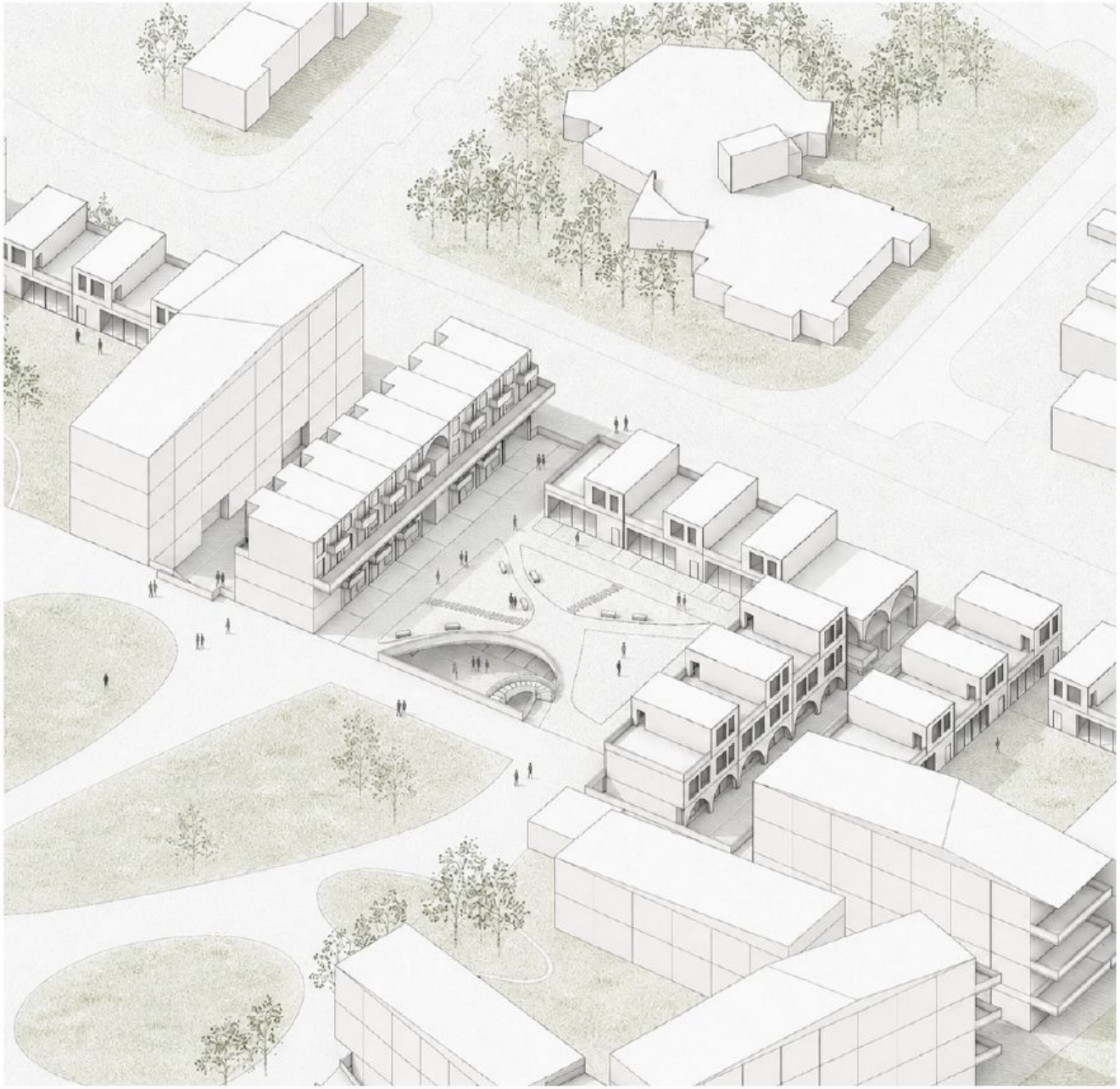






06 REFLECTION

REFLECTION



Green Stitch is not only about connecting places, but creating continuity between landscape, community and everyday living.

01 From Barrier to Connector

The project began with the railway corridor as a physical barrier between communities in South Collyhurst. By reimagining this edge as continuous green infrastructure, the proposal creates new connections between parks, housing and neighbourhoods while improving ecological continuity and everyday movement.

02 From Vision to Design Code

Through the design code, the vision of Green Stitch is translated into clear spatial principles. Movement, Built Form & Use, Open Space & Nature, Identity and Homes work together to guide connected streets, shared courtyards, diverse housing types and a stronger sense of local character.

03 Future Development

Further development would focus on environmental performance, construction details and long-term adaptability. Particular attention could be given to material reuse, low-carbon construction and the integration of green infrastructure with everyday residential comfort.

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DESIGN JOURNALS

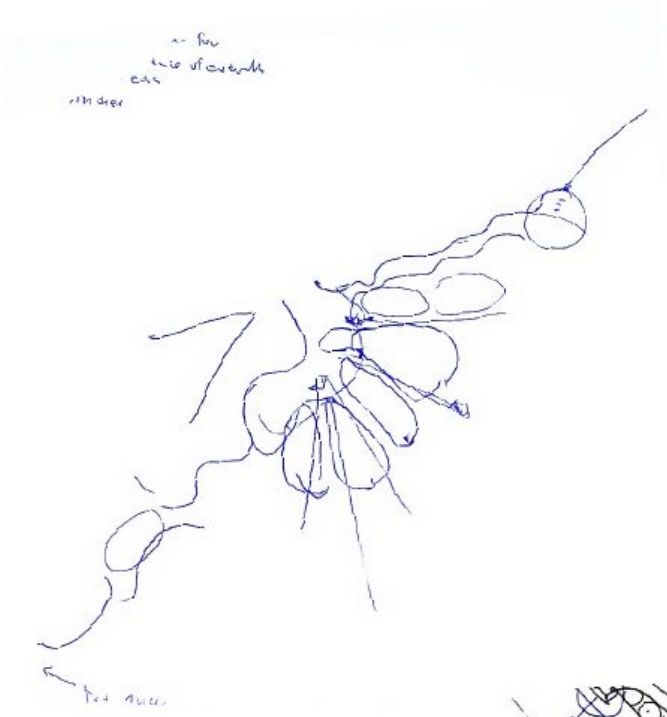
Week 1 to Week 3

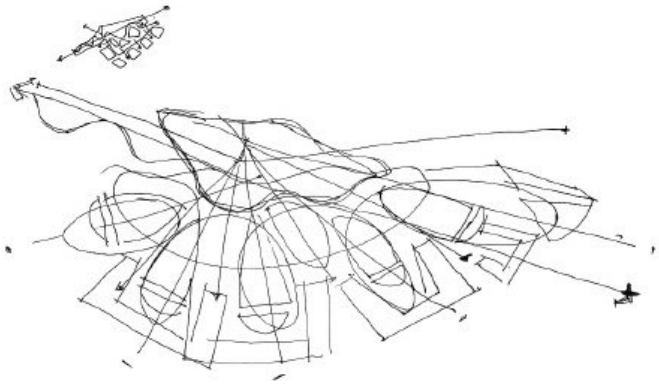
Early Concept Exploration

During Weeks 1–3, I began by revisiting the masterplan developed in Studio B and questioning how the central green space could become more than an open area between housing blocks. Early workshops and group discussions focused on the relationship between landscape, movement and the surrounding neighbourhood.

Through a series of hand sketches, I experimented with branching and organic geometries inspired by natural growth patterns. These studies explored how paths could extend from a central landscape and respond to surrounding streets, housing and existing green spaces.

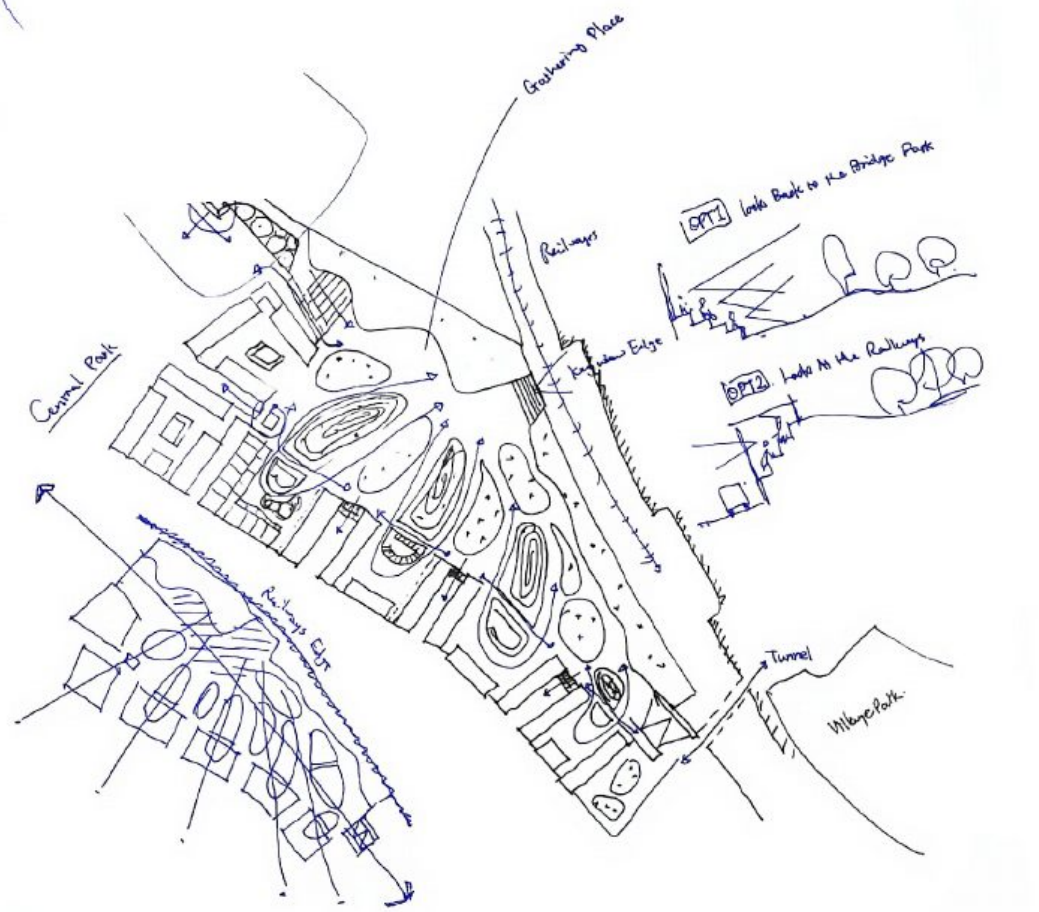
Rather than defining a fixed park form at this stage, the sketches established an initial idea of the landscape as a connecting structure, which later developed into the wider Green Stitch strategy.







Testing early ideas through collaborative discussion.



Materplan Draft, Junyu, May 2026

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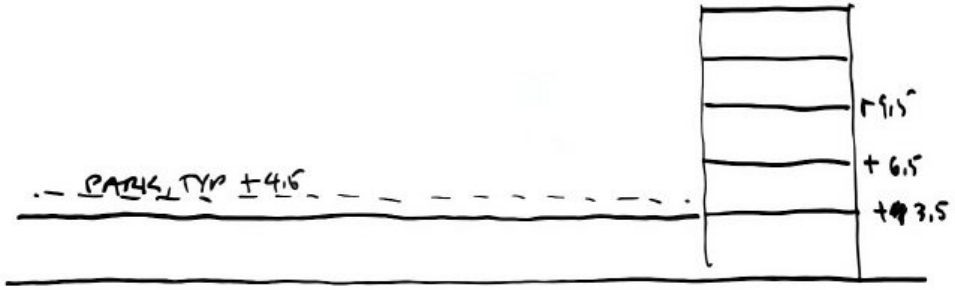
Week 4 to Week 5

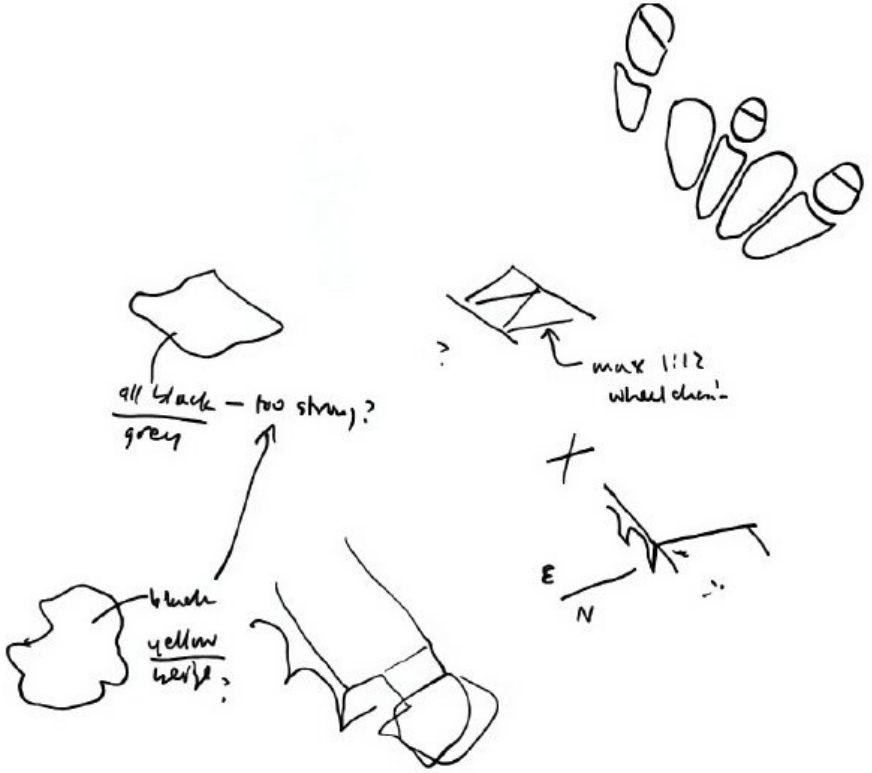
Precedent Study & Spatial Refinement

During Weeks 4–5, precedent studies helped develop the relationship between landscape, housing and public space. Section sketches tested the level change of the raised park, while further studies refined paths, planting and building edges within the masterplan.

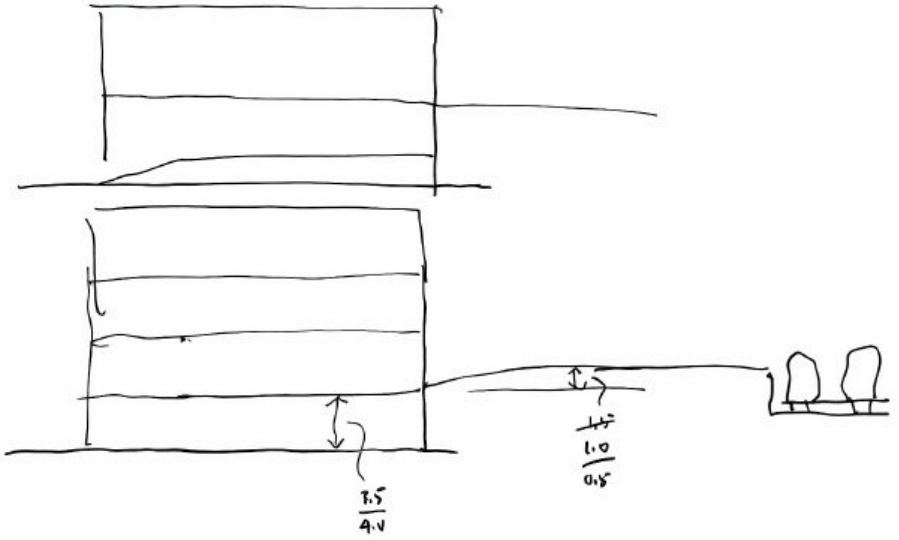


Design code precedent sharing, David, 2026





"Main actions" notes in tutorials, David, 2026



calculating levels and slope

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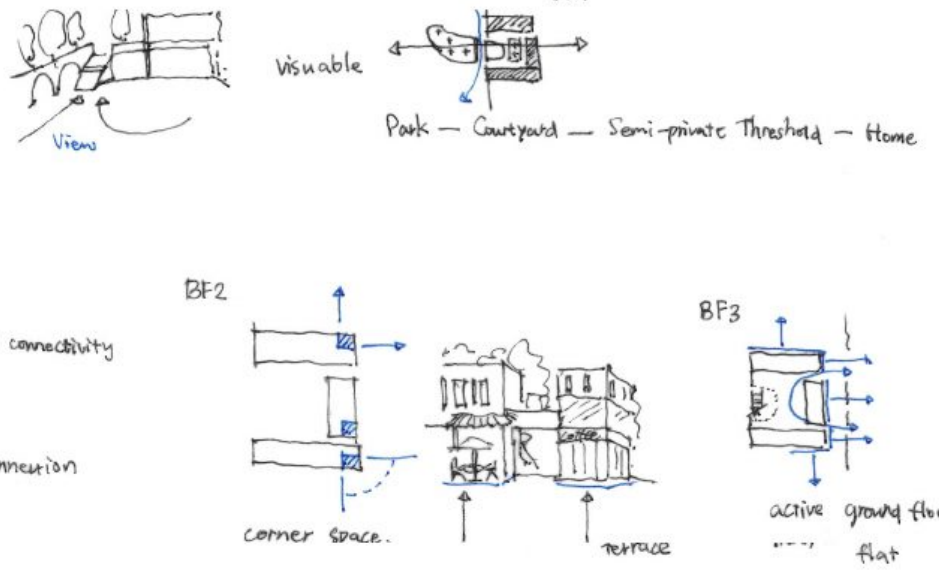
Week 5 to Week 7

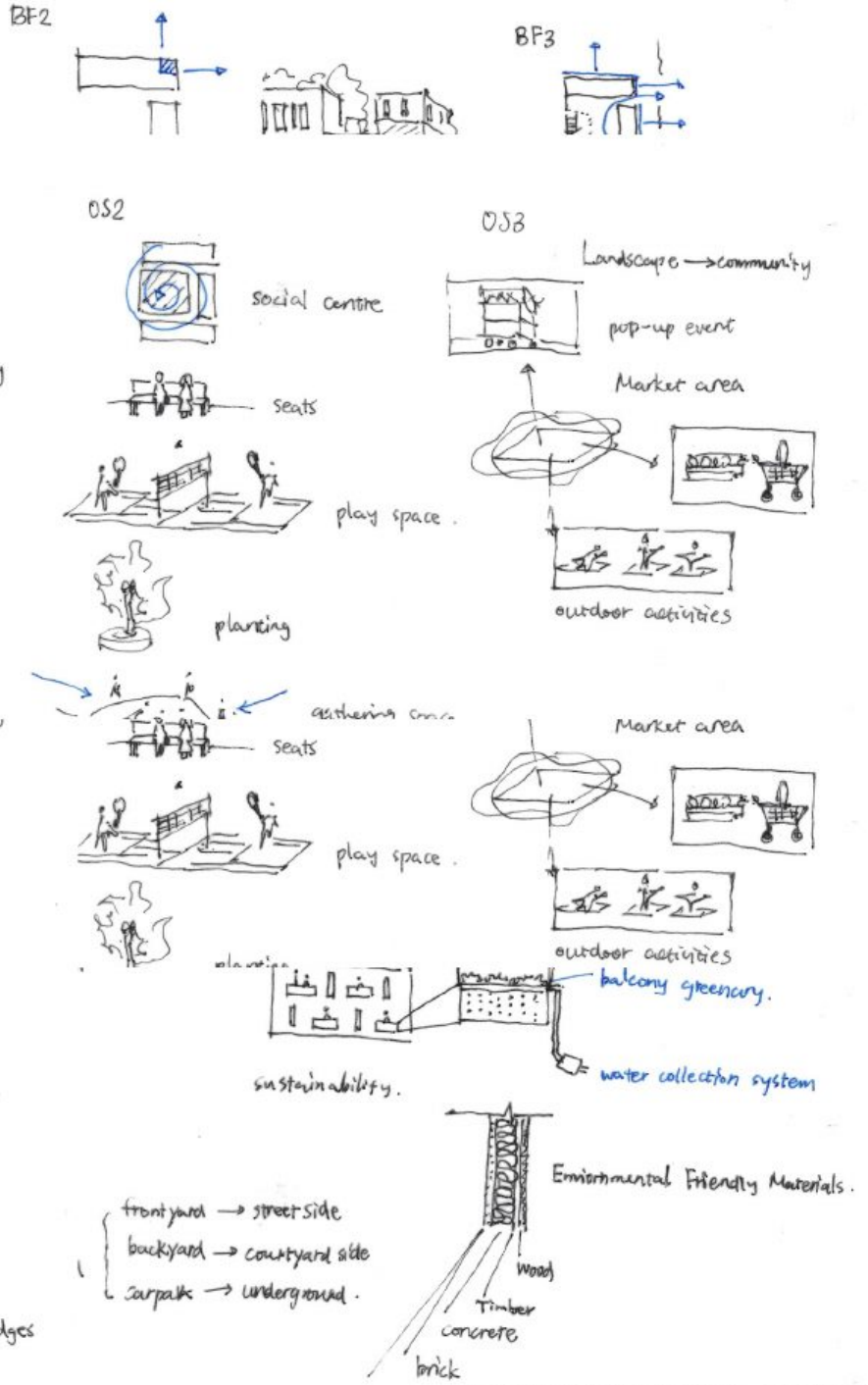
Design Code Development

During Weeks 5–7, I began translating the overall masterplan strategy into a more structured design code. Early drafts explored how the main ideas of the project could be organised into a series of clear spatial principles rather than remaining as individual design decisions.

Precedent studies were used to understand how design codes can guide development across different scales. This helped establish the five main categories of Movement, Built Form & Use, Open Space & Nature, Identity, and Homes, connecting the wider urban strategy with block and housing-scale decisions.

Through sketches and diagram testing, the codes were gradually refined and applied back to the masterplan. This process helped ensure that the final proposal developed as a consistent system, linking green infrastructure, movement, residential quality and local identity.





Design code Draft, Junyu, May 2026

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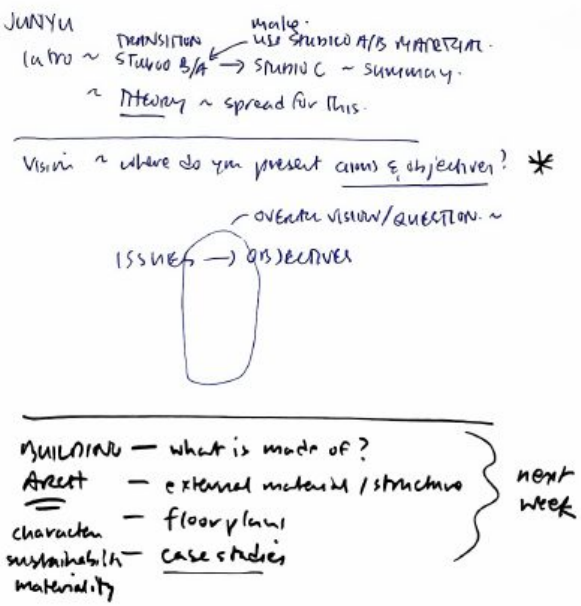
Week 8 to Week 10

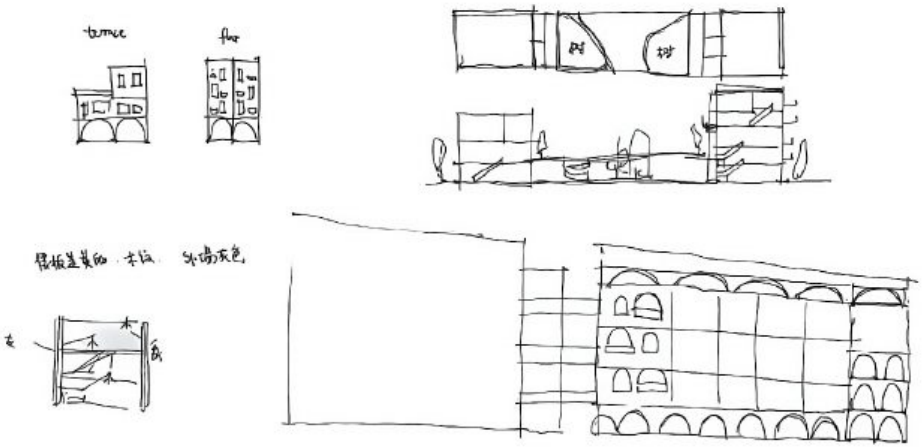
Housing & Material Development

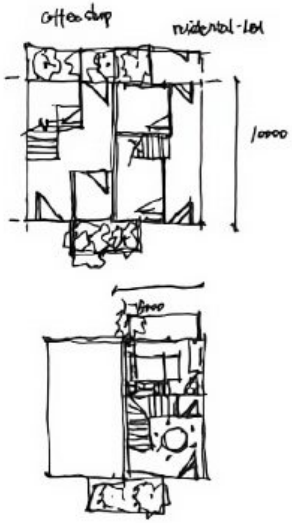
During Weeks 8–10, the design code developed towards the housing scale, exploring different unit types and spatial arrangements. The relationship between apartments, terrace houses, balconies and circulation was tested through sketches.

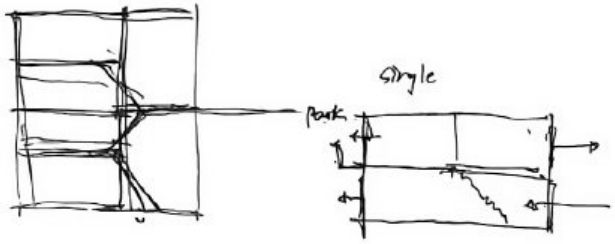
The design also began to consider structure and materiality, including timber and steel construction, brick façades and lightweight elements.

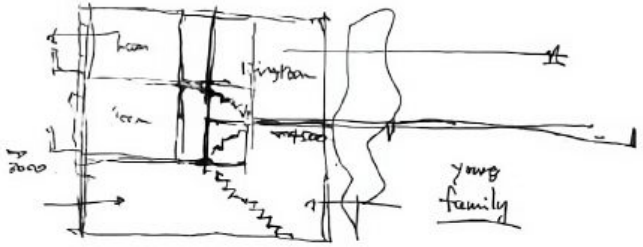
Façade studies explored proportions, openings and arched elements, connecting the new housing language with the existing viaduct and the architectural identity of Collyhurst.



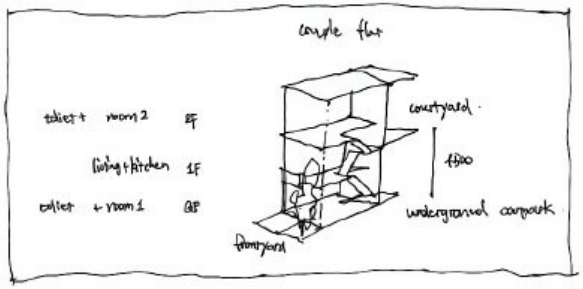




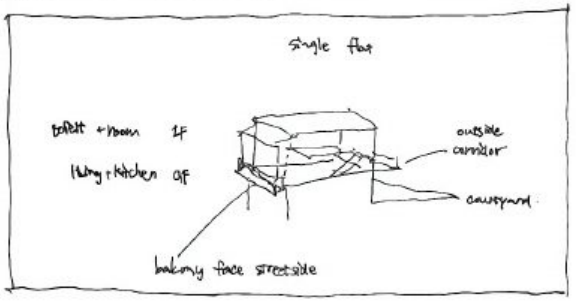




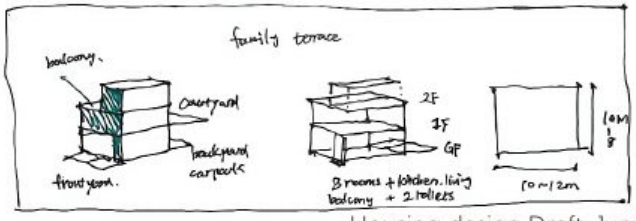
flat type



OR Studio workshop



terrace type



Housing design Draft, Junyu, May 2026

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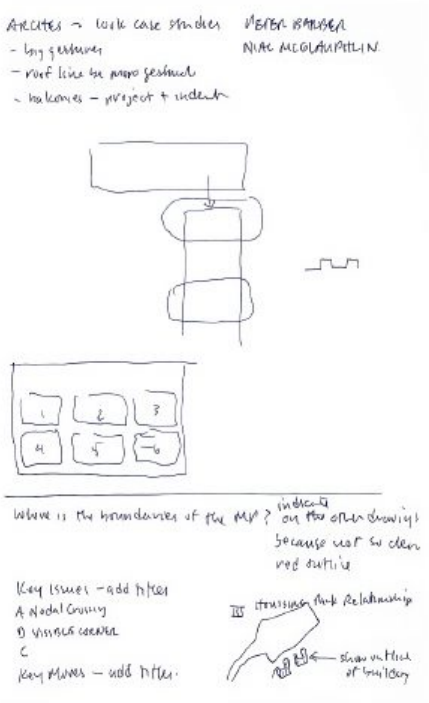
11-Final

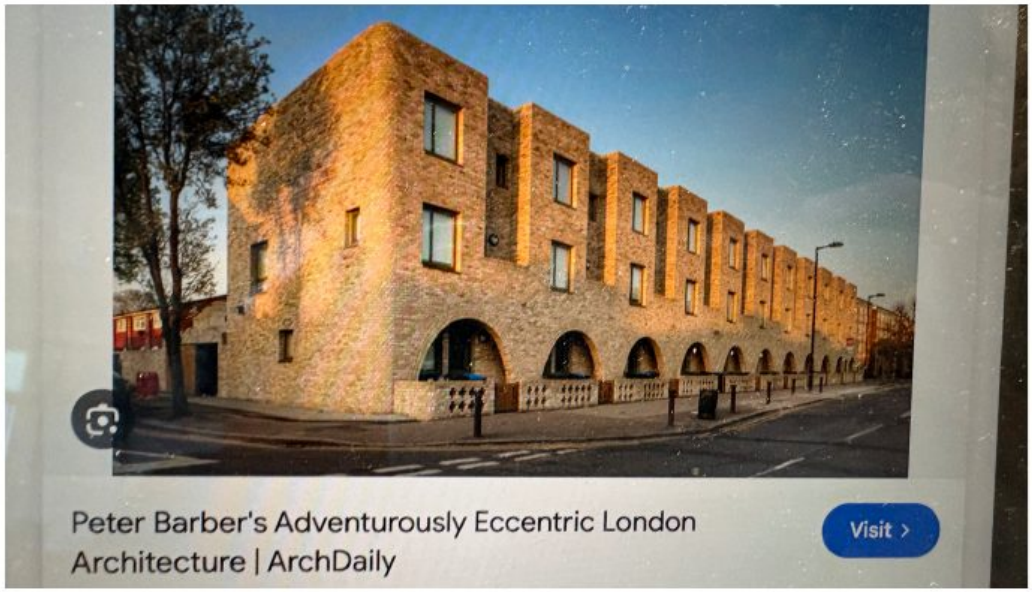
Final Development & Review

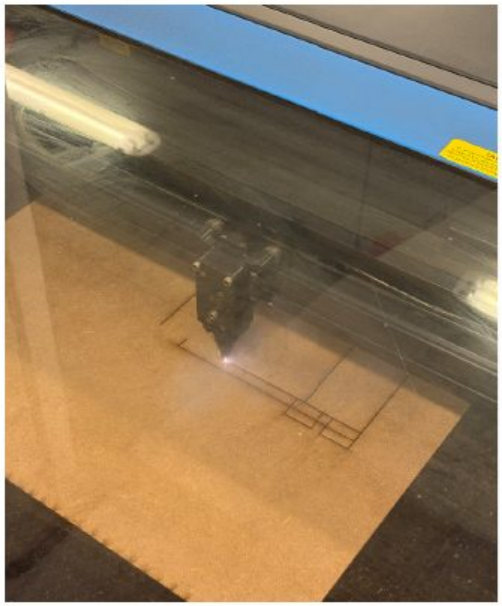
During the final stage, a physical model was produced to test the relationship between housing, circulation and the courtyard at a more detailed scale. This helped evaluate spatial proportions and how the design code could be translated into architectural form.

The pin-up review provided further precedent suggestions, particularly around arched elements, façade character and residential identity. These references helped refine the relationship between the new housing and the existing architectural language of Collyhurst.

Feedback also focused on the portfolio structure, visual hierarchy and clarity of communication. The final stage therefore involved refining drawings, diagrams and page layouts to create a more consistent presentation of the design process and final design code.









Making physical model in B.15, Junyu, May 2026



Pin up in studios gallery, Junyu, May 2026

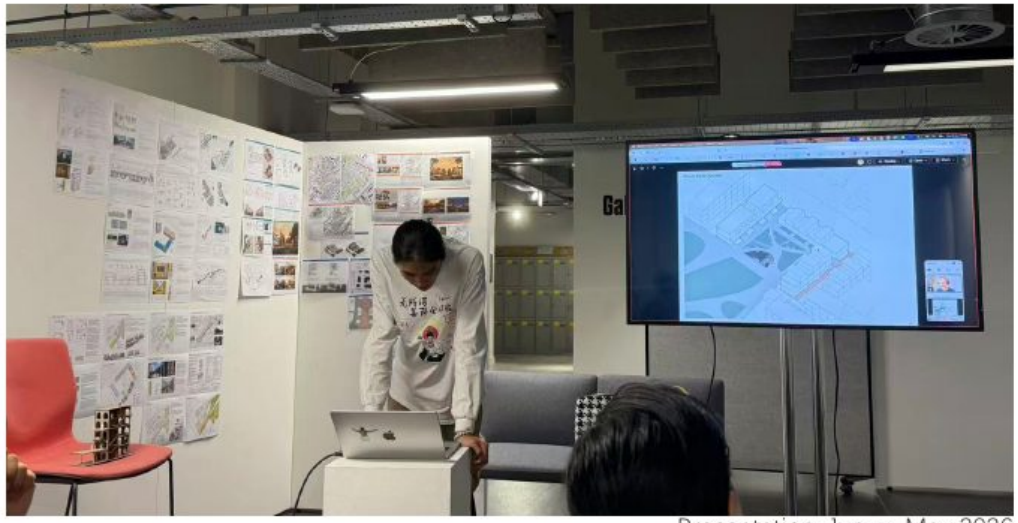
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Last Tutorial & Acknowledgements

The final tutorial marked the conclusion of the design code development, bringing together the research, design exploration and reflections developed throughout the studio. The final presentation and discussion provided an opportunity to review the project as a complete journey.

My sincere thanks to **Dr David** and **Dr Azreen** for their guidance, encouragement and thoughtful feedback throughout the studio. I am also deeply grateful to all the tutors and friends at the Manchester School of Architecture for the inspiring discussions, support, collaboration and memorable moments we shared.

It has been a meaningful journey of learning, designing and growing together. Wishing everyone all the very best for the journey ahead.



Precentation, Junyu, May 2026









Instax Films , May 2026









Disposible Camera Films by Yunshu, May 2026

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